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1 Thessalonians - Introduction

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Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of 1 Thessalonians

1. Opening and blessing (1:1)
2. Giving thanks for the Thessalonians (1:2–10)

- A prayer of thanks (1:2–5)
- The Thessalonians as examples (1:6–10)

1. The visit with the Thessalonians (2:1–16)

- How Paul and his fellow workers behaved (2:1–12)
- How the Thessalonians responded (2:13–16)

1. Separation from the Thessalonians (2:17–20)
2. Timothy's visit and good news (3:1–10)
3. A benediction (3:11–13)
4. Teaching on sexual morality (4:1–8)
5. Teaching on Christian love (4:9–12)
6. Teaching on the day of the Lord (4:13–5:11)

- Dead believers and the day of the Lord (4:13–18)
- The timing of the day of the Lord (5:1–11)

1. Final Commands (5:11–22)
2. Closing (5:23–28)

Who wrote the book of 1 Thessalonians?
The author identifies himself as Paul the apostle, and he writes that Silvanus and Timothy agree with what he says. In fact, throughout this letter, Paul commonly uses the plural pronouns "we" and "us" to refer to himself, Silvanus, and Timothy. Paul was originally from the city of Tarsus but lived in Jerusalem. He had been known as Saul in his early life. Before becoming a Christian, Paul was a Pharisee, and he persecuted Christians. After he became a Christian, he traveled several times throughout the Roman Empire, telling people about Jesus. Paul first visited the Thessalonians during his second time traveling around the Roman Empire (see Acts 17:1–10). When people started persecuting the Christians in Thessalonica, Paul went to a city named Berea. Then he traveled to Athens and then to Corinth, where Timothy met him after visiting the Thessalonians (see Acts 17:10–18:5). When Timothy told Paul how the Thessalonians were doing, Paul wrote this letter to them in response.

What is the book of 1 Thessalonians about?
Paul wrote 1 Thessalonians to make his relationship with the Thessalonians stronger and to teach them more about the gospel. He needed to do both of these things because, after he preached the gospel to the Thessalonians, persecution forced him to leave after only a few weeks.

First, Paul wants the Thessalonians to know how much he was concerned about them and how joyful and thankful he was when he learned from Timothy that they were doing well. To accomplish this goal, he reminds the Thessalonians of how he and his fellow workers acted, he reminds the Thessalonians of how they responded, and he tells them how happy he is about the good news that Timothy brought. He tells them all these things to make his relationship with them stronger.

After accomplishing this goal, he moves on to his second goal, which is to teach them more things about the gospel. It is possible that he was not able to teach some of these topics before he had to leave them. The primary topic he addresses is related to the day of Lord, the time in the future when Jesus will come back to this world. He also teaches them about sexual morality, loving fellow believers, the Holy Spirit, prophecies, and several other topics.

How should the title of this book be translated?
Translators may choose to call this book by its traditional title, "First Thessalonians" or "1 Thessalonians." Or they may choose a different title, such as "Paul's First Letter to the Church in Thessalonica" or "A First Letter to the Christians in Thessalonica." (See: How to Translate Names)

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

What was the city of Thessalonica like?
The city of Thessalonica was an important city in the province of Macedonia, which is in the northern part of what we now call Greece. Thessalonica was important because it had a harbor and major roads going through the city and because it was the capital of the province. Because it was an important city, there were people from many cultures and religions there, including Jews. Most people in the city worshiped many gods, including the emperors of Rome.

The "day of the Lord" and the "coming of the Lord"
The phrase "the day of the Lord" refers to the specific time in the future when Jesus will return to this world. Paul calls this event "the coming of the Lord." Christians believe that, when Jesus comes back, God will resurrect all people, and Jesus will judge everyone, punish unbelievers, and reward believers. In this letter,

1 Thessalonians - Chapter 1 Introduction

Paul teaches the Thessalonians about what will happen to believers who have died before this "day" (see 4:13–18). He also teaches the Thessalonians about how to expect and prepare for this "day" (see 5:1–11).

Why were the Thessalonians concerned about believers who had died?
It is possible that Paul had to leave the Thessalonians before he finished teaching about what will happen when Jesus comes back. It is also possible that the Thessalonians thought that Jesus would come back before any believers died. We cannot be sure about the reason why they were concerned, but it is clear that they were afraid that believers who had died would not experience all the amazing and good things that will happen when Jesus comes back. Paul reassures them that believers who have died will live again and meet Jesus before anyone who is still alive meets him. Because of that, the Thessalonians do not need to be concerned about believers who have died.

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

What did Paul mean by the expressions like "in Christ," "in the Lord," etc.?
Paul frequently uses the spatial metaphor "in Christ" (often with another name for Christ, such as Lord or Jesus) in this letter. This metaphor emphasizes that believers are as closely united to Christ as if they were inside him. Paul believes that this is true for all believers, and sometimes he uses "in Christ" simply to identify that what he is speaking about is true for those who believe in Jesus. Other times, he emphasizes union with Christ as the means or the basis for some statement or exhortation. See the notes on specific verses for help in understanding the contextual meaning of "in Christ" and related phrases. (See: Metaphor)

What did Paul mean by the word "brothers"?
Paul often uses the term "brothers" to mean people who share the same faith. Although this term is masculine, Paul uses the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If you decide to retain this figurative usage in your translation, you could state "brothers and sisters" to indicate that the word has this generic sense. (See: When Masculine Words Include Women)

"We" and "you"
In this letter, unless a note specifies otherwise, the words "we," "us," and "our" always refer to Paul and his fellow workers, particularly Silvanus and Timothy, and do not include the Thessalonians. Also, in this letter, the words "you" and "your" are always plural. (See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'; and Forms of 'You' — Singular)

What are the major issues in the text of the book of 1 Thessalonians?
In the following verses, ancient manuscripts do not all have the same words. The ULT uses the words that are found in most of the earliest manuscripts. When you translate these verses, you should compare the ULT with any translations with which your readers may be familiar to see what your readers may expect. Unless there is a good reason to use the alternate words, you should follow the ULT. See the footnotes and notes at each of these verses for more information. (See: Textual Variants)

- "Grace to you and peace" (1:1). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ."
- "little children" (2:7). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "gentle."
- "boasting" (2:19). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "great joy."
- "a servant of God" (3:2). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "a fellow worker of God." Other ancient manuscripts have this: "fellow worker." Other ancient manuscripts have this: "a servant of God and our fellow worker."
- "God ... God" (3:9). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "Lord ... Lord."
- "the one giving" (4:8). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "the one having given."
- "to you" (4:8). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "to us."
- "you have" (4:9). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "we have."
- "thieves" as the object of a verb (5:4). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "thief" as the subject of a verb.
- "Test all things" (5:21). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "But test all things."
- "all the brothers" (5:27). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "all the holy brothers."
- "with you" (5:28). Some ancient manuscripts have this: "with you. Amen."

1 Thessalonians - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Opening and blessing (1:1)

2. Giving thanks for the Thessalonians (1:2–10)

- A prayer of thanks (1:2–5)
- The Thessalonians as examples (1:6–10)

Verse 1 formally introduces this letter. Letters in the ancient Near East commonly had introductions of this type in which the senders identified themselves and the recipient and then gave a greeting.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Trinity
God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit are mentioned numerous times in this chapter. Paul can speak of each of them individually, but he describes them working together as God. Make sure that your translation distinguishes between Father, Son, and Holy Spirit but still identifies them as God.

Imitators and examples
In 1:8, Paul describes how the Thessalonians became "imitators" of the apostles and of Jesus. They became "imitators" when they suffered but still experienced joy from the Holy Spirit. Paul then describes how this behavior made them "examples" for other believers to imitate (see 1:7–8). Make sure that your translation indicates that the Thessalonians are imitating the apostles and Christ, which means that other people should imitate them.

The second coming
In 1:10, Paul refers to the "second coming," a specific day in the future in which Jesus will come back to earth, all dead people will come back to life, the world will be renewed, and God will judge people, punishing those who have sinned but rewarding those who believe in Jesus and obey him. Paul's focus in this verse is especially on God's judgment. Consider whether your readers will infer this information from what Paul says in 1:10 or whether you should include some of this implied information.

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#1)

Παῦλος, καὶ Σιλουανὸς, καὶ Τιμόθεος; τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ

"Paul and Silvanus and Timothy, to the church"

Your language may have a particular way of introducing the author of a letter and its intended audience. For example, you may want to indicate that this is a letter. Alternate translation: [I, Paul, along with Silvanus and Timothy, wrote this letter to you, the church]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#5)

Θεῷ Πατρὶ καὶ Κυρίῳ Ἰησοῦ Χριστῷ

"God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ"

When **God** is called **Father**, it highlights his relationship to **Jesus** the "Son" (see 1:10). Here, the Old Testament title for **God**, **Lord**, is applied to **Jesus**, equating him with **God**. Be sure to retain these titles in your translation.

See: Translating Son and Father

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#9)

χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη

"Grace to you and peace"

Many ancient manuscripts read **Grace to you and peace**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read "Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#2)

Παῦλος, καὶ Σιλουανὸς, καὶ Τιμόθεος; τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ

"Paul and Silvanus and Timothy, to the church"

Paul is the author of this letter. **Silvanus and Timothy** are with him as he writes and are in agreement with what he writes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [I, Paul, together with Silvanus and Timothy, write to the church]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#3)

Σιλουανὸς

"Silvanus"

The name **Silvanus** is a longer form of the name **Silas**, the form of the name used for this same man in the book of Acts. You could choose to use the shorter form here as well, or you could choose to use the longer form here and include a footnote explaining that they are forms of the same name.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#4)

ἐν Θεῷ Πατρὶ καὶ Κυρίῳ Ἰησοῦ Χριστῷ

“in God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ”

Here Paul uses the spatial metaphor **in God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ** to describe the union of believers with **God** and **Christ**. In this case, being **in God** and **Christ**, or united to God and Christ, identifies the Thessalonians as Christians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that indicates that the Thessalonians have a very close relationship with **God** and **Christ**. Alternate translation: [that is united to God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ] or [in union with God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#7)

χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη

“Grace to you and peace”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Grace** and **peace**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [I pray that God will be favorable to you and give you a peaceful spirit]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#6)

χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη

“Grace to you and peace”

After stating his name and the people to whom he is writing, Paul adds a blessing. Use a form that people would recognize as a blessing in your language. Alternate translation: [May you experience kindness and peace within you] or [I pray that you will have grace and peace]

See: Blessings

1 Thessalonians 1:1 (#8)

ὑμῖν

“to you”

Throughout this letter the word **you** is plural and refers to the Thessalonian believers, unless otherwise noted.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Thessalonians 1:2 (#2)

πάντοτε & ἀδιαλείπτως

“always & continually”

Paul says **always** and **continually** here as generalizations for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [very regularly … extremely often]

See: Hyperbole

1 Thessalonians 1:2 (#1)

εὐχαριστοῦμεν τῷ Θεῷ πάντοτε περὶ πάντων ὑμῶν, μνείαν ποιούμενοι ἐπὶ τῶν προσευχῶν ἡμῶν, ἀδιαλείπτως

“We give thanks to God always for all of you, making mention {of you} in our prayers continually”

Here Paul first states what he, Silvanus, and Timothy do more specifically (they **give thanks to God**) and then describes it more generally (they are **making mention** of the Thessalonians). If it would be clearer in your language, you could reverse the order of the clauses. Alternate translation: [We continually make mention of you in our prayers, always giving thanks to God for all of you]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 1:2 (#3)

μνείαν ποιούμενοι ἐπὶ τῶν προσευχῶν ἡμῶν, ἀδιαλείπτως

“making mention {of you} in our prayers continually”

Here, the word **continually** could modify: (1) **making mention {of you}**. Alternate translation: [making mention of you continually in our prayers]; (2) “remembering” in the following verse (1:3). If you use the following alternate translation, you will need to omit the comma at the end of this verse. Alternate translation: [making mention of you in our prayers, continually]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 1:3 (#3)

ὑμῶν τοῦ ἔργου τῆς πίστεως

“your work of faith”

Here, Paul could be using the possessive form to describe **work** that is: (1) a result of **faith**. Alternate translation: [your work produced by faith]; (2) a proof

of **faith**. Alternate translation: [your work that proves that you have faith]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 1:3 (#2)

ὑμῶν τοῦ ἔργου τῆς πίστεως, καὶ τοῦ κόπου τῆς ἀγάπης, καὶ τῆς ὑπομονῆς τῆς ἐλπίδος τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"your work of faith and labor of love and endurance of hope of our Lord Jesus Christ"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **faith**, **love**, **endurance**, and **hope**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [how you work because you believe, and how you labor because you love, and how you endure because you hope in our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 1:3 (#8)

ἡμῶν

"our"

In both places, the word **our** includes Paul, Silvanus, Timothy, the Thessalonians, and all believers. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 1:3 (#1)

μνημονεύοντες ὑμῶν τοῦ ἔργου τῆς πίστεως, καὶ τοῦ κόπου τῆς ἀγάπης, καὶ τῆς ὑπομονῆς τῆς ἐλπίδος τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ Πατρὸς ἡμῶν

"remembering your work of faith and labor of love and endurance of hope of our Lord Jesus Christ before our God and Father"

Here, when Paul says that he and those with him are **remembering** things **before our God and Father**, he means that they are thanking God about specific things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [gratefully mentioning to our God and Father your work of faith and labor of love and endurance of hope of our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:3 (#6)

τῆς ἐλπίδος τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"of hope of our Lord Jesus Christ"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **hope** that is based in **our Lord Jesus Christ**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [of hope in our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 1:3 (#5)

τῆς ὑπομονῆς τῆς ἐλπίδος

"endurance of hope"

Here, Paul could be using the possessive form to describe **endurance** that is: (1) a result of **hope**. Alternate translation: [endurance produced by hope]; (2) a characteristic of **hope**. Alternate translation: [enduring hope]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 1:3 (#7)

τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ Πατρὸς ἡμῶν

"our God and Father"

Here, **our God and Father** refers to the one divine person who is both God and Father. The word **God** and the word **Father** refer to the same person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [God our Father] or [our Father God]

See: Hendiadys

1 Thessalonians 1:3 (#4)

τοῦ κόπου τῆς ἀγάπης

"labor of love"

Here, Paul could be using the possessive form to describe **labor** that is: (1) a result of **love** for other believers. Alternate translation: [labor produced by love for others]; (2) a result of **love** for God. Alternate translation: [labor produced by love for God]; (3) a proof of **love**. Alternate translation: [labor that proves that you have love]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 1:4 (#3)

ἀδελφοὶ

"brothers"

Throughout the letter, although the term **brothers** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If you retain the metaphor in your translation, and if it would be helpful

in your language, you could say “brothers and sisters” to indicate this.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 1:4 (#4)

ἠγαπημένοι ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“loved by God”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom God is loving]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 1:4 (#2)

ἀδελφοὶ

“brothers”

Here and throughout the letter, Paul uses the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [believing friends]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 1:4 (#5)

τὴν ἐκλογὴν ὑμῶν

“your election”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **election**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [that you have been chosen] or [that God has selected you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 1:4 (#1)

εἰδότες

“knowing”

Here, the word **knowing** introduces a reason why Paul and those with him give thanks to God (see 1:2). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason. Alternate translation: [which we do because we know] or [since we know]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 1:5 (#2)

τὸ εὐαγγέλιον ἡμῶν οὐκ ἐγενήθη εἰς ὑμᾶς

“our gospel did not come to you”

Here, Paul speaks of **our gospel** as if it were a person who could **come to you**. He means that the Thessalonians heard the gospel from Paul and his fellow workers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you did not receive our gospel]

See: Personification

1 Thessalonians 1:5 (#1)

ὅτι

“because”

Here, **because** introduces a reason why Paul and those with him are sure about the Thessalonians’ “election” (see 1:4). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason for a previous statement. Alternate translation: [which we are sure about because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 1:5 (#5)

ἐν δυνάμει, καὶ ἐν Πνεύματι Ἁγίῳ, καὶ πληροφορίᾳ πολλῇ

“in power and in the Holy Spirit and in much assurance”

Here Paul could mean that: (1) Paul and those with him preached the gospel with **power** and with the help of **the Holy Spirit** and with **much assurance** that what they preached was true. Alternate translation: [we preached with power and with the Holy Spirit and with much assurance that it is true]; (2) the Thessalonians experienced **power** and **the Holy Spirit** and **much assurance** when they heard the gospel. Alternate translation: [you experienced its power and the presence of the Holy Spirit and much assurance that it is true]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:5 (#6)

καθὼς οἴδατε οἷοι

“just as you know what kind {of men”

Here, the phrase **just as you know** could introduce: (1) a basis for Paul’s claim about how the Thessalonians experienced the gospel. Alternate translation: [and you know that is true because you remember what kind of men]; (2) a comparison between what Paul has said about how the Thessalonians experienced the gospel and what the Thessalonians know about Paul

and his fellow workers. Alternate translation: [and that fits with what you know about what kind of men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:5 (#4)

ἐν δυνάμει, καὶ ἐν Πνεύματι Ἁγίῳ, καὶ πληροφορίᾳ πολλῇ

"in power and in the Holy Spirit and in much assurance"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **power** and **assurance**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [in us acting powerfully and in the Holy Spirit working and in us being fully assured]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 1:5 (#3)

ἐν λόγῳ

"in word"

Paul is using the term **word** to refer to speaking words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in speech] or [in spoken words]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 1:6 (#1)

ὑμεῖς & ἐγενήθητε

"you yourselves became"

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun **you**, which is already implied in the verb **became**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **yourselves**. Alternate translation: [it is you who became]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 1:6 (#5)

μετὰ χαρᾶς Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

"with joy of the Holy Spirit"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **joy**, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [rejoicing because of the Holy Spirit]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 1:6 (#2)

δεξάμενοι

"having received"

Here, the phrase **having received** could introduce: (1) the way in which the Thessalonians **became imitators**. Alternate translation: [that is, you received]; (2) when the Thessalonians **became imitators**. Alternate translation: [which you did when you received]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Thessalonians 1:6 (#6)

μετὰ χαρᾶς Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

"with joy of the Holy Spirit"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe **joy** that is given by **the Holy Spirit**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [with joy from the Holy Spirit] or [with joy given by the Holy Spirit]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 1:6 (#4)

ἐν θλίψει πολλῇ

"in much affliction"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **affliction**, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [while being afflicted] or [while people made you suffer]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 1:6 (#3)

τὸν λόγον

"the word"

Here, **the word** represents a message that is made up of words, specifically the gospel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the gospel message] or [the words of the gospel]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 1:7 (#2)

γενέσθαι ὑμᾶς τύπους πᾶσιν τοῖς πιστεύουσιν ἐν τῇ Μακεδονίᾳ καὶ ἐν τῇ Ἀχαΐᾳ

"you became examples to all the ones believing in Macedonia and in Achaia"

If your language would not use the abstract noun **examples**, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [you showed all the ones believing in Macedonia and in Achaia how to behave] or [all the ones believing in Macedonia and Achaia started to copy how you live]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 1:7 (#3)

ἐν τῇ Μακεδονίᾳ καὶ ἐν τῇ Ἀχαΐᾳ

"in Macedonia and in Achaia"

The word **Achaia** is the name of a Roman province in the southern part of modern-day Greece. The word **Macedonia** is the same of a Roman province in the northern part of modern-day Greece. If it would be helpful in your language, you could clarify that these words are names of provinces or regions. Alternate translation: [in the regions of Macedonia and Achaia]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Thessalonians 1:7 (#1)

ὥστε

"so that"

Here, the phrase **so that** introduces a result from how the Thessalonians became imitators of Paul, his fellow workers, and the Lord (see 1:6). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a result. Alternate translation: [and as a result] or [and so]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#9)

ἐν παντὶ τόπῳ

"into every place"

Here Paul speaks as if people in **every place** know about Thessalonians' faith. The Thessalonians would have understood him to mean that their faith is known in many places, or in every place that Paul and his fellow workers visit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into every place we go] or [throughout the world]

See: Hyperbole

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#2)

ἀφ' ὑμῶν & ἐξήχηται ὁ λόγος τοῦ Κυρίου

"from you the word of the Lord has been sounded out"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you have sounded out the word of the Lord]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#8)

ἡ πίστις ὑμῶν ἡ πρὸς

"your faith toward"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the way that you believe in]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#6)

ἐν παντὶ τόπῳ ἡ πίστις ὑμῶν ἡ πρὸς τὸν Θεὸν ἐξελήλυθεν

"your faith toward God has gone out into every place"

Here Paul speaks as if the Thessalonians' **faith** were a person who could travel to many places. He means that people in many places have heard about their **faith**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people have heard about your faith toward God in every place] or [news of your faith toward God has been heard in every place]

See: Personification

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#10)

λαλεῖν τι

"to say anything"

Here Paul implies that he does not **need to say anything** about the Thessalonians' faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea explicit. Alternate translation: [to say anything about your faith]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#3)

ὁ λόγος τοῦ Κυρίου

"the word of the Lord"

Paul is using the term **word** to refer to the message about **the Lord**, which is the gospel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the good news about the Lord]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces an explanation of how the Thessalonians became examples throughout Macedonia and Achaia. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an explanation. Alternate translation: [More specifically,] or [Indeed,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#5)

ἐν τῇ Μακεδονίᾳ καὶ ἐν τῇ Ἀχαΐᾳ

"in Macedonia and in Achaia"

See how you translated the similar phrases in 1:7. Alternate translation: [in the regions of Macedonia and Achaia]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#4)

ἐξήχηται

"has been sounded out"

Here, Paul speaks as if the Thessalonians were playing an instrument that makes a sound that can be heard from far away. He means that people in many places hear **the word of the Lord** because of how the Thessalonians act. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or express the idea plainly. Alternate translation: [has shone forth] or [has been heard]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 1:8 (#7)

ἡ πίστις ὑμῶν

"your faith"

Here, the word **faith** represents knowledge about the Thessalonians' **faith**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the news about your faith] or [knowledge concerning your faith]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 1:9 (#8)

Θεῷ ζῶντι καὶ ἀληθινῷ

"the living and true God"

Here, the phrase **living and true God** identifies God as the one who lives and is truly God. The point is that God actually lives, unlike idols and other things that people may call gods, and that God really is God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that emphasizes that God really lives and is the true God. Alternate translation: [the real God who actually lives] or [the only true God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:9 (#6)

ἐπεστρέψατε πρὸς τὸν Θεὸν ἀπὸ τῶν εἰδώλων

"you turned to God from the idols"

Paul speaks of the Thessalonians as if they had been facing toward their **idols** and then **turned** around to face toward **God**. He means that they no longer worship idols, and now they worship God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you started worshiping God and left the idols behind] or [you abandoned the idols for God's sake]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 1:9 (#5)

ὁποίαν εἴσοδον ἔσχομεν πρὸς ὑμᾶς

"what kind of entrance we had to you"

Here Paul refers to his and his fellow workers' visit to the Thessalonians as an **entrance**. He implies that the Thessalonians welcomed him and that it was a good visit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this idea more explicitly. Alternate translation: [what a good visit we had with you] or [how wonderful it was when we visited you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:9 (#3)

αὐτοὶ & ἀπαγγέλλουσιν

"they themselves report"

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun **they**, which is already implied in the verb **report**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **themselves**. Alternate translation: [as for them, they report] or [it is they who report]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 1:9 (#4)

ἡμῶν

"us"

Here, the word **us** could include: (1) just Paul and his fellow workers. Alternate translation: [us who preached the good news]; (2) Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [you and us]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 1:9 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces a reason why Paul and his fellow workers do not need to say anything about the Thessalonians (see 1:8). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason. Alternate translation: [In fact,] or [That is because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 1:9 (#2)

αὐτοὶ & ἀπαγγέλλουσιν

"they themselves report"

Here, the phrase **they themselves** refers to everyone who has heard about the Thessalonians' faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the pronouns more explicit. Alternate translation: [they themselves who have heard about your faith report]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 1:9 (#7)

δουλεύειν

"to serve"

Here, the phrase **to serve** could introduce: (1) the purpose for which the Thessalonians **turned**. Alternate translation: [in order to serve]; (2) a restatement of what it means for the Thessalonians to have **turned**. Alternate translation: [that is, you chose to serve]; (3) the result the Thessalonians having **turned**. Alternate translation: [with the result that you serve]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#2)

τὸν Υἱὸν αὐτοῦ

"his Son"

Son is an important title for Jesus that describes his relationship to God the Father.

See: Translating Son and Father

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#1)

καὶ ἀναμένειν

"and to wait for"

The phrase **to wait** is parallel with the phrase "to serve" in the previous verse (1:9). Introduce it the same way you introduced "to serve." Alternate translation: [and in order to wait for] or [and with the result that you wait for]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#9)

τῆς ὀργῆς τῆς ἐρχομένης

"the coming wrath"

Paul speaks of **wrath** as though it were someone who could travel and is **coming** to where people are. He means that in the future God will act wrathfully against people who have sinned and who have not trusted in Jesus to forgive their sins. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this plainly. Alternate translation: [God's judgment that will happen] or [when God will punish people for sin]

See: Personification

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#4)

ἤγειρεν ἐκ τῶν νεκρῶν

"he raised from the dead"

Here, the phrase **raised from the dead** refers to someone who died and came back to life. If your language does not use **raised** to describe coming back to life, you could use a comparable idiom or express the idea plainly. Alternate translation: [he restored to life after he had died]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#6)

Ἰησοῦν, τὸν ῥυόμενον ἡμᾶς

“Jesus, the one rescuing us”

The clause **the one rescuing us** describes Jesus in his role as rescuer. Paul is not distinguishing between more than one **Jesus**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that makes this explicit. Alternate translation: [Jesus, our rescuer] or [Jesus, who rescues us]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#7)

ἡμᾶς

“us”

Here, the word **us** includes Paul, Silvanus, Timothy, the Thessalonians, and all Christians. Your language may require you to mark these forms. Alternate translation: [all of us Christians] or [all of us believers]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#5)

τῶν νεκρῶν

“the dead”

Paul is using the adjective **dead** as a noun in order to refer to people who are **dead**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this one with a noun phrase. Alternate translation: [the dead people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#3)

ἐκ τῶν οὐρανῶν

“from the heavens”

Here Paul assumes that the Thessalonians know that Jesus ascended into **the heavens** and will someday come back to earth from there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this information more explicit. Alternate translation: [to return from his place in the heavens] or [to come back to earth after he ascended into the heavens]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 1:10 (#8)

ἐκ τῆς ὀργῆς τῆς ἐρχομένης

“from the coming wrath”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wrath**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [from the time when God punishes people] or [so that God does not punish us in the future]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. The visit with the Thessalonians (2:1–16)
   - How Paul and his fellow workers behaved (2:1–12)
   - How the Thessalonians responded (2:13–16)
1. Separation from the Thessalonians (2:17–20)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Paul’s previous visit with the Thessalonians
Before he wrote this letter, Paul had briefly visited the city of Thessalonica and preached the gospel. He may have been in this city for only three weeks (see Acts 17:2), but many people still believed in Jesus during this time. They started the church of the Thessalonians, to whom Paul wrote this letter. However, Paul had to leave the city quickly because some Jewish people started a riot and tried to seize Paul and his fellow workers. You can read about this story in Acts 17:1–10. In this chapter, Paul describes how he and his fellow workers acted when he visited them, and he describes how the believers responded (see 2:1–13). He also refers to how some Jewish people persecuted him and his fellow workers (see 2:15–16). Finally, he describes how he wants to visit them again after he and his fellow workers had to leave so soon (see 2:17–20).

God and the Thessalonians as “witnesses”
In 2:5 and 2:10, Paul names God as a “witness” to what he is saying, and he also names the Thessalonians as “witnesses” in 2:10. Witnesses testify about whether something is true, so Paul names God and the Thessalonians as witnesses to show the Thessalonians that what he is saying is true. Your language may have a specific form for appealing to someone to guarantee that a statement is true.

“The Jews”
In 2:14–16, Paul refers to people whom he calls “the Jews.” He does not mean Jewish people in general, since he refers to “the churches of God that are in Judea” as a separate group, and most if not all of these people were Jewish. Paul himself clarifies that he means “the ones having killed both the Lord Jesus and the prophets and having persecuted us.” This does not describe one group of people only, since many of

the people who killed God's "prophets" died before Jesus came. What it does describe is a type of person: a person who opposes God and his messengers. When Paul refers to "the Jews" in this chapter, then, he is referring to Jewish people who oppose God and his messengers. You may need to make this more explicit in your translation. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Figures of speech related to families
In this chapter, Paul describes himself and his fellow workers as "little children" (2:7), "mothers" (2:7), and "fathers" (2:11). He also refers to the Thessalonians as "brothers" (2:1, 9, 14, 17). Paul describes himself and his fellow workers in these ways to show the Thessalonians that he and his fellow workers love and care about them as if they were members of the same family. Paul especially emphasizes this since he was only with the Thessalonians for a short period of time. If possible, preserve the figures of speech that describe the Thessalonians, Paul, and his fellow workers as members of the same family.

1 Thessalonians 2:1 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces a longer explanation of the "entrance" that Paul and his fellow workers had among the Thessalonians (see 1:9). This explanation is found in 2:1–12. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an explanation of a previous statement. Alternate translation: [Concerning our entrance to you,] or [Now about your visit,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 2:1 (#4)

οὐ κενὴ γέγονεν

"has not been in vain"

Paul is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning, **in vain**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [has definitely been worthwhile] or [has been very useful]

See: Litotes

1 Thessalonians 2:1 (#3)

τὴν εἴσοδον ἡμῶν τὴν πρὸς ὑμᾶς

"our entrance to you"

Here, just as in 1:9, Paul refers to his and his fellow workers' visit to the Thessalonians as an **entrance**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [that our visit with you] or [that our time with you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:1 (#2)

αὐτοὶ & οἴδατε

"you yourselves know"

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun **you**, which is already implied in the verb **know**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **yourselves**. Alternate translation: [as for you, you know] or [it is you who know]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#2)

προπαθόντες καὶ ὑβρισθέντες, καθὼς οἴδατε, ἐν Φιλίπποις

"having previously suffered and having been mistreated at Philippi, just as you know"

These words provide background information about what happened when Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy were in the city of Philippi. You can read about this in Acts 16:16–40. Use a natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [even though we suffered and were shamefully treated when we were in Philippi, just as you know]

See: Background Information

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#5)

ὑβρισθέντες

"having been mistreated"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [having experienced mistreatment] or [people having mistreated us]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#4)

προπαθόντες καὶ ὑβρισθέντες

“having previously suffered and having been mistreated”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize how much the apostles suffered. If your language does not use repetition in this way, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [having earlier suffered violently] or [having already been shamefully abused]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#7)

ἐν τῷ Θεῷ ἡμῶν

“in our God”

Here Paul uses the spatial metaphor **in God** to describe the union of believers with **God**. In this case, being **in God**, or united to God, explains how Paul and his fellow workers were able to be **bold**. Paul could mean more specifically that: (1) **God** enabled them to be bold. Alternate translation: [with boldness from God]; (2) they were bold because of their union with **God**. Alternate translation: [because of our union with God]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#1)

ἀλλὰ

“But”

Here, the word **But** introduces a contrast with how Paul and his fellow workers might have visited the Thessalonians “in vain” (see 2:1). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces this kind of contrast. Alternate translation: [Rather,] or [Instead of acting in vain,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#8)

τὸ εὐαγγέλιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the gospel of God”

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **gospel** that relates to **God**. More specifically, the **gospel** could: (1) come from God. Alternate translation: [the gospel that God gave us]; (2) be about God. Alternate translation: [the gospel about God]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#6)

ἀλλὰ προπαθόντες καὶ ὑβρισθέντες, καθὼς οἴδατε, ἐν Φιλίπποις

“But having previously suffered and having been mistreated at Philippi, just as you know”

Here Paul includes the phrase **just as you know** at the end of the information that he says they **know**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could move **just as you know** to wherever it would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But, just as you know, having previously suffered and having been shamefully treated at Philippi]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#9)

ἐν πολλῷ ἀγῶνι

“in much struggle”

Here, the phrase **much struggle** could refer: (1) generally to how difficult preaching the gospel was. Alternate translation: [in great difficulty]; (2) specifically to people who opposed Paul. Alternate translation: [in much opposition]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:2 (#3)

προπαθόντες καὶ ὑβρισθέντες

“having previously suffered and having been mistreated”

Here, the phrases **having previously suffered and having been shamefully treated** refer to something that contrasts with **we were bold**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could introduce the phrases **having previously suffered and having been shamefully treated** with a word or phrase that introduces a contrast or something that is unexpected. Alternate translation: [despite having previously suffered and having been shamefully treated] or [even though we suffered previously and were shamefully treated]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Thessalonians 2:3 (#4)

οὐκ ἐκ πλάνης

“was} neither from error”

Here Paul could be implying that the **exhortation** was not **from error** because: (1) he and his fellow workers did not try to convince the Thessalonians to believe what is wrong. Alternate translation: [was neither

from false teaching]; (2) he and his fellow workers did not believe what is wrong. Alternate translation: [was neither from false beliefs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:3 (#3)

ἡ & παράκλησις ἡμῶν

"our exhortation"

Here Paul could be implying that this **exhortation** was addressed to: (1) the Thessalonians specifically. Alternate translation: [our exhortation to you]; (2) anyone to whom Paul and his fellow workers proclaim the gospel. Alternate translation: [our exhortation to people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:3 (#2)

ἡ & παράκλησις ἡμῶν οὐκ ἐκ πλάνης, οὐδὲ ἐξ ἀκαθαρσίας, οὐδὲ ἐν δόλῳ

"our exhortation {was} neither from error, nor from impurity, nor in deceit"

If your language does not use nouns for some or all of the ideas in this verse, you could express the ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [when we appealed to you, we did not lead you astray, nor did we speak impurely, nor did we deceive you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 2:3 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces an explanation of how Paul and his fellow workers spoke the gospel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an explanation, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Here is how we spoke:] or [Indeed,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 2:4 (#1)

καθὼς δεδοκιμάσμεθα ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ, πιστευθῆναι τὸ εὐαγγέλιον, οὕτως λαλοῦμεν

"just as we have been examined by God to be entrusted with the gospel, so we speak"

Here Paul describes the manner in which he and his fellow workers **speak** something before he says that they **speak**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could rearrange the elements so that Paul says what he is doing before he describes the manner in which he does it. Alternate translation: [we speak as those who have been examined by God to be entrusted with the gospel]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 2:4 (#2)

δεδοκιμάσμεθα ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ, πιστευθῆναι

"we have been examined by God to be entrusted with"

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the idea with active forms or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God has examined us to entrust us with]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 2:4 (#5)

τὰς καρδίας ἡμῶν

"our hearts"

In Paul's culture, the heart is the place where humans think and plan. If it would be helpful in your language, you could refer to the place where humans think in your culture or express the idea plainly. Alternate translation: [our minds] or [what we think]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 2:4 (#3)

πιστευθῆναι

"to be entrusted with"

Here, the phrase **to be entrusted** introduces the result of being **examined by God**. Paul implies that God approved of them when he **examined** them, and so they were **entrusted with the gospel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that introduces the result of a test or examination. Alternate translation: [with the result that we were entrusted with] or [and approved to be entrusted with]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 2:4 (#4)

ἀλλὰ Θεῷ

"but to God"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in

the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but as pleasing to God]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 2:5 (#3)

ποτε

“at that time”

Here, the phrase **at that time** refers to the time when Paul and his fellow workers visited the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [at the time of our visit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:5 (#5)

λόγῳ κολακίας

“a word of flattery”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **flattery**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a flattering word]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 2:5 (#4)

ἐν λόγῳ κολακίας

“in a word of flattery”

Paul is using the term **word** to mean a message in words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in a message of flattery] or [in speech of flattery]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 2:5 (#7)

ἐν προφάσει πλεονεξίας

“in a pretext of greed”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **pretext** and **greed**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [by disguising how greedy we might have been] or [being greedy and trying to hide it]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 2:5 (#2)

οὔτε γάρ ποτε ἐν λόγῳ κολακίας ἐγενήθημεν, καθὼς οἴδατε

“For we were not at that time in a word of flattery, just as you know”

Here Paul includes the phrase **just as you know** in the middle of the information that he says they know. If it would be helpful in your language, you could move **just as you know** to wherever it would be natural in your language. See how you translated the similar form in 2:2. Alternate translation: [For just as you know, we were not at that time in a word of flattery]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 2:5 (#1)

γάρ

“For”

Here, the word **For** introduces further explanation of how Paul and his fellow workers spoke and acted. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an explanation, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Further,] or [Even more,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 2:5 (#8)

Θεὸς μάρτυς

“God {is} witness”

The phrase **God {is} witness** is an oath formula. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [we swear by God] or [as God knows]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Thessalonians 2:5 (#6)

προφάσει πλεονεξίας

“a pretext of greed”

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **pretext** that hides or disguises **greed**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a pretext for greed] or [a pretext that hides greed]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 2:6 (#2)

ἀνθρώπων

“men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and

women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [humans] or [men and women]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 2:6 (#1)

ἐξ ἀνθρώπων δόξαν, οὔτε ἀφ' ὑμῶν, οὔτε ἀπ' ἄλλων

"glory from men, neither from you nor from others"

If your language does not use the abstract noun **glory**, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for men, neither you nor others, to praise us]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 2:7 (#3)

νήπιοι

"little children"

Here, many ancient manuscripts read **little children**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read "gentle." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 2:7 (#1)

δυνάμενοι ἐν βάρει εἶναι

"being able to be a burden"

Here Paul speaks as if he and his fellow workers could have made the Thessalonians carry something heavy. He means that he and his fellow workers could have made the Thessalonians' lives harder. More specifically, the **burden** could be: (1) Paul and his fellow workers demanding respect and obedience. Alternate translation: [being able to require your obedience]; (2) Paul and his fellow workers demanding money and other things. Alternate translation: [being able to demand money from you]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:7 (#6)

ἐν μέσῳ ὑμῶν, ὡς ἐὰν τροφὸς θάλπῃ τὰ ἑαυτῆς τέκνα

"in the midst of you, as if a mother might comfort her own children"

Here, the clause **as if a mother might comfort her own children** could be: (1) a further explanation of what Paul has already said about how they acted like **children**. Alternate translation: [in the midst of you, just as a mother might comfort her own children]; (2) a description of what he is about to say about how they long for the Thessalonians (see 2:8). If you use the following alternate translation, you will need to continue the sentence in the following verse instead of starting a new sentence there. Alternate translation: [in the midst of you. As a mother might comfort her own children,]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 2:7 (#5)

ὡς ἐὰν τροφὸς θάλπῃ τὰ ἑαυτῆς τέκνα

"as if a mother might comfort her own children"

The point of this comparison is that in the same way a **mother** would gently **comfort her own children**, so the apostles gently and affectionately cared for the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the meaning more explicit. Alternate translation: [and we loved you like mother who affectionately cares for her own children] or [as we affectionately cared for you]

See: Simile

1 Thessalonians 2:7 (#2)

ἐγενήθημεν νήπιοι

"we became little children"

Here, Paul speaks as if he and his fellow workers **became little children**. He means that they treated the Thessalonians gently and did not use their authority harshly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly or use a simile. Alternate translation: [we acted as mild as infants] or [we behaved gently]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:7 (#4)

ἐν μέσῳ ὑμῶν

"in the midst of you"

Alternate translation: [among you] or [when we visited you]

1 Thessalonians 2:8 (#4)

τὰς ἑαυτῶν ψυχάς

"our own souls"

Here, the word **souls** represents people and focuses particularly on who people are and what they do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [our own selves]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 2:8 (#3)

τὸ εὐαγγέλιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the gospel of God"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe **the gospel** that relates to **God** (see the similar phrase in 2:2). More specifically, the **gospel** could: (1) come from **God**. Alternate translation: [the gospel that God gave us]; (2) be about **God**. Alternate translation: [the gospel about God]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 2:8 (#1)

οὕτως

"in this manner"

Here, the phrase **in this manner** could: (1) refer back to what Paul said in the previous verse about how he and his fellow workers love and care for the Thessalonians as if they were the Thessalonians' mothers. Alternate translation: [in that very way] or [as a mother does]; (2) make the word **longing** stronger. Alternate translation: [so very much]; (3) refer ahead to what Paul and his fellow workers did because of their **longing**. Alternate translation: [in the following way:]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:8 (#2)

εὐδοκοῦμεν

"we were pleased"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we were happy] or [we considered it good]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 2:9 (#1)

γάρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces a reason why the Thessalonians should believe Paul when he writes that he and his fellow workers loved and cared for them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason or basis for a claim, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [You know that is true because] or [In fact,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 2:9 (#5)

τὸ εὐαγγέλιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the gospel of God"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe **the gospel** that relates to **God** (see the similar phrase in 2:8). More specifically, the **gospel** could: (1) come from **God**. Alternate translation: [the gospel that God gave us]; (2) be about **God**. Alternate translation: [the gospel about God]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 2:9 (#3)

νυκτὸς καὶ ἡμέρας

"night and day"

Here, the phrase **night and day** indicates that Paul and his fellow workers worked during both the day and the night. This means that they worked very much every day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the time] or [always]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 2:9 (#4)

πρὸς τὸ μὴ ἐπιβαρῆσαί τινα ὑμῶν

"in order not to burden any of you"

Here Paul speaks of asking for money as if it were a heavy **burden** that he and his fellow workers could have asked the Thessalonians to carry for them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or plain language. Alternate translation: [so that none of you would have to support us financially] or [in order not to make life hard for any of you]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:9 (#2)

τὸν κόπον ἡμῶν καὶ τὸν μόχθον

"our labor and toil"

Here, **labor** and **toil** mean basically the same thing. The repetition emphasizes how hard the apostles

worked. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [our toilsome labor] or [how hard we worked]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 2:10 (#1)

ὑμεῖς μάρτυρες καὶ ὁ Θεός, ὡς

"You and God {are} witnesses, how"

Here Paul speaks as if he were summoning both the Thessalonians and God as **witnesses** to testify on their behalf before a judge. He means that both the Thessalonians and God know how he and his fellow workers acted. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You and God can declare how] or [You and God know how]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:10 (#2)

ὡς ὁσίως, καὶ δικαίως, καὶ ἀμέμπτως

"how piously and righteously and blamelessly"

The terms **piously**, **righteously**, and **blamelessly** mean similar things. Paul is using the three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with only one or two terms. Alternate translation: [righteously] or [properly and purely]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 2:11 (#1)

ὡς ἕνα ἕκαστον ὑμῶν, ὡς πατὴρ τέκνα ἑαυτοῦ

"how, {with} each one of you, as a father his own children"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous verse if it would be clearer in your language (see 2:10). Alternate translation: [how we were with each one of you as a father is with his own children] or [how we treated each one of you as a father treats his own children]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 2:11 (#2)

ὡς πατὴρ τέκνα ἑαυτοῦ

"as a father his own children"

The point of Paul's comparison is that Paul and his fellow workers are like fathers who model and instruct proper behavior for their **children**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the meaning more explicit. Alternate translation: [as a father teaches and trains his own children] or [we taught and disciplined you as fathers do with their own children]

See: Simile

1 Thessalonians 2:12 (#1)

παρακαλοῦντες ὑμᾶς, καὶ παραμυθούμενοι, καὶ μαρτυρόμενοι

"exhorting you and encouraging and testifying"

Here, the words **exhorting**, **encouraging**, and **testifying** describe ways in which Paul and his fellow workers acted like fathers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [by exhorting you and encouraging you and testifying to you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:12 (#2)

παρακαλοῦντες ὑμᾶς, καὶ παραμυθούμενοι

"exhorting you and encouraging"

The terms **exhorting** and **encouraging** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [exhorting you]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 2:12 (#6)

τοῦ καλοῦντος ὑμᾶς

"the one calling you"

Here Paul is adding more information about God. He is not distinguishing between different gods. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that clearly adds information instead of distinguishing between people. Alternate translation: [who is the one calling you]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 2:12 (#7)

εἰς τὴν ἑαυτοῦ βασιλείαν καὶ δόξαν

"into his own kingdom and glory"

Here, the phrase **kingdom and glory** could refer: (1) to two distinct things that God calls his people to partic-

ipate in. Alternate translation: [into his own kingdom and his own glory]; (2) to one thing described with two words connected by **and**. This is called hendiadys. Alternate translation: [into his own glorious kingdom]

See: Hendiadys

1 Thessalonians 2:12 (#3)

μαρτυρόμενοι

"testifying"

Here Paul could be implying that he and his fellow workers testify: (1) about how believers should behave. Alternate translation: [testifying about proper behavior]; (2) to the truth of the good news. Alternate translation: [testifying to the truth of the gospel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:12 (#5)

ἀξίως τοῦ Θεοῦ

"worthily of God"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe what **God** considers to be worthy. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in a way that honors God] or [in a way that God considers worthy]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 2:12 (#4)

εἰς τὸ περιπατεῖν ὑμᾶς

"in order that you might walk"

Paul speaks of behavior in life as if it were walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in order that you might act] or [in order that you might live your lives]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:13 (#4)

λόγον ἀκοῆς & λόγον ἀνθρώπων & λόγον Θεοῦ

"the word of hearing & as} the word of men & the word of God"

In this verse, Paul uses the term **word** to mean a message that is spoken by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the spoken message of hearing ... something spoken by men ... something spoken by God]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 2:13 (#5)

λόγον ἀκοῆς παρ' ἡμῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the word of hearing of God from us"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **word** that he connects with **hearing** and with **God**. He could mean that: (1) the **word** allowed the Thessalonians to hear about **God**. Alternate translation: [the word in which you heard about God from us]; (2) the **word** is what the Thessalonians heard from Paul and his fellow workers, and this **word** is about **God**. Alternate translation: [the word which you heard from us about God]; (3) the **word** is from **God**, and the Thessalonians heard it from Paul and his fellow workers. Alternate translation: [the word from God which you heard from us]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 2:13 (#2)

καὶ ἡμεῖς

"we also"

Here, the word **also** could imply that: (1) Paul and his fellow workers thank God about the Thessalonians like other people do (see 1:8–10). Alternate translation: [we too]; (2) Paul and his fellow workers are thanking God for additional things about the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [we yet again]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:13 (#1)

καὶ διὰ τοῦτο καὶ ἡμεῖς εὐχαριστοῦμεν τῷ Θεῷ ἀδιαλείπτως, ὅτι

"And because of this, we also thank God continually, that"

Here, the word **this** could refer to: (1) what Paul is about to write, which he introduces with the word **that**. Alternate translation: [And here is why we also thank God constantly: it is that]; (2) what Paul has already written about how Paul and his fellow workers preached and how the Thessalonians welcomed them. Alternate translation: [And because of those things, we also thank God constantly, that]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 2:13 (#6)

ἀνθρώπων

"of men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [of humans] or [of people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 2:13 (#3)

ἀδιαλείπτως

"continually"

Paul says **continually** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. See how you translated the similar form in 1:2. Alternate translation: [extremely often]

See: Hyperbole

1 Thessalonians 2:13 (#7)

ὃς

"which"

Here, the word translated **which** could refer to: (1) **the word**. Alternate translation: [which word]; (2) **God**. Alternate translation: [who]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 2:13 (#8)

ὃς καὶ ἐνεργεῖται

"which is also working"

Here Paul refers to **the word of God** as if it were a person doing work. He means that God uses **the word** to work in the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [through which God is also working] or [which is also effective]

See: Personification

1 Thessalonians 2:14 (#7)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"the Jews"

Here Paul is referring to Jewish people who did not believe in Jesus and who persecuted those who did believe in Jesus. He is not referring to Jewish people in general, since **the churches of God that are in Judea** were mostly Jewish people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make it more explicit that Paul is speaking about **Jews** who did not believe and who persecuted other Jewish people who did believe. Alternate translation: [the Jews who did not believe in Jesus] or [the Jews who opposed Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:14 (#2)

τῶν ἐκκλησιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"of the churches of God"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe **churches** that belong to **God**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea without using the possessive form. Alternate translation: [of the churches that belong to God]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 2:14 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces proof of how God's message is working among the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces proof or support for a claim. Alternate translation: [We know it is working in you because] or [Indeed,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 2:14 (#3)

ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ

"in Christ Jesus"

Here Paul uses the spatial metaphor **in Christ Jesus** to describe the union of believers with **Christ Jesus**. In this case, being **in Christ Jesus**, or united to Christ, explains that **churches** are truly believers and have a relationship with Christ. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that indicates that these believers are united to Christ. Alternate translation: [and that are united to Christ Jesus] or [and that are in union with Christ Jesus]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:14 (#4)

τὰ αὐτὰ ἐπάθετε, καὶ ὑμεῖς ὑπὸ τῶν ἰδίων συμφυλετῶν, καθὼς καὶ αὐτοὶ ὑπὸ τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"the same things you also suffered from your own countrymen, just as they also from the Jews"

Here, the phrase **the same things** points to the phrase **just as they also from the Jews**. Paul means that the Thessalonians and the believers **in Judea** experienced

the same kind of suffering and persecution. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. You may need to rearrange the end of the verse to do so. Alternate translation: [you also suffered from your own countrymen exactly what they also suffered from the Jews] or [whatever they also suffered from the Jews you also suffered from your own countrymen]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 2:14 (#6)

καὶ αὐτοὶ ὑπὸ

"they also from"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [they also suffered these things from]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 2:14 (#5)

τῶν ἰδίων συμφυλετῶν

"your own countrymen"

Although the term **countrymen** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [others from your own country] or [people who live in your city]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 2:14–15 (#1)

To help your readers understand the author's main point in this verse and the next one, you could combine both verses into a verse bridge. You could include what the unbelieving **Jews** did first and then include how the Thessalonians are **imitators** of the believers in Judea. Alternate translation: [For the Jews, the ones having killed both the Lord Jesus and the prophets and having persecuted us, made the churches of God that are in Judea in Christ Jesus suffer. Now you, brothers, became imitators of them, because the same things you also suffered from your own countrymen, just as they also from the Jews, the ones not being pleasing to God and {being} hostile to all men,]

See: Verse Bridges

1 Thessalonians 2:15 (#3)

τοὺς προφήτας

"the prophets"

Here, the phrase **the prophets** refers to the prophets who are mentioned in the Old Testament. These prophets were also Jewish and spoke God's message to his people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [the Jewish prophets] or [God's prophets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:15 (#4)

πᾶσιν ἀνθρώποις

"to all men"

Paul says **all men** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [to very many men] or [to the majority of men]

See: Hyperbole

1 Thessalonians 2:15 (#2)

τῶν καὶ τὸν Κύριον ἀποκτεινάντων Ἰησοῦν, καὶ τοὺς προφήτας, καὶ ἡμᾶς ἐκδιωξάντων

"the ones having killed both the Lord Jesus and the prophets and having persecuted us"

This list of those persecuted by the people whom Paul calls "the Jews" is not chronological but emphasizes the order of importance and intensity of persecution. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the order of events clear. Alternate translation: [the ones having killed the prophets, then the Lord Jesus, and finally persecuting us]

See: Order of Events

1 Thessalonians 2:15 (#1)

τῶν καὶ τὸν Κύριον ἀποκτεινάντων Ἰησοῦν, καὶ τοὺς προφήτας, καὶ ἡμᾶς ἐκδιωξάντων; καὶ Θεῷ μὴ ἀρεσκόντων, καὶ πᾶσιν ἀνθρώποις ἐναντίων

"the ones having killed both the Lord Jesus and the prophets and having persecuted us and not being pleasing to God and {being} hostile to all men"

Paul provides this background information about "the Jews" to help readers understand exactly which Jews he is speaking about. Use the natural form in your language for expressing background information. Alternate translation: [by which I mean the Jews who in

the past killed both the Lord Jesus and the prophets and persecuted us and who are not pleasing God and who are hostile to all men]

See: Background Information

1 Thessalonians 2:15 (#5)

πᾶσιν ἀνθρώποις

"to all men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [to all men and women]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#2)

λαλῆσαι

"to speak"

Here Paul implies that he and his fellow workers speaks the gospel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [to speak the gospel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#4)

σωθῶσιν

"they might be saved"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, it is clear from the context that it is God. Alternate translation: [God might save them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#1)

κωλυόντων

"forbidding"

Here, the word **forbidding** could introduce: (1) a reason why Paul says that the unbelieving Jews are not "pleasing to God" and are "hostile to all men" (see 2:15). Alternate translation: [because they forbid] or [which is because they forbid]; (2) the means by which the unbelieving Jews act in ways that are not "pleasing to God" and "hostile to all men" (see 2:15). Alternate translation: [which they do by forbidding]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#8)

ἡ ὀργὴ

"the wrath"

Here Paul implies that **the wrath** is God's **wrath**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [God's wrath]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#5)

εἰς τὸ ἀναπληρῶσαι αὐτῶν τὰς ἁμαρτίας πάντοτε

"so that {they} always fill up their sins"

Here Paul is referring to how the unbelieving Jews **fill up their sins**. He does not mean that **the Gentiles** who are saved are filling up their sins. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [so that these unbelieving Jews always fill up their sins]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#6)

εἰς τὸ ἀναπληρῶσαι αὐτῶν τὰς ἁμαρτίας πάντοτε

"so that {they} always fill up their sins"

Here, Paul speaks of how the unbelieving Jews sin as if it were filling something up with sins. He could mean: (1) that they commit many sins all the time. Alternate translation: [so that they commit many sins at many times]; (2) that they commit enough sins that God will punish them. Alternate translation: [so that they always commit enough sins for God to punish them]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#3)

τοῖς ἔθνεσιν & ἵνα σωθῶσιν

"to the Gentiles so that they might be saved"

Here, the clause **so that they might be saved** expresses the purpose for which Paul and his fellow workers **speak to the Gentiles**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this connection more explicit. Alternate translation: [to the Gentiles, which we do so that they might be saved]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#10)

εἰς τέλος

"to the end"

Here, the phrase **to the end** could mean that God's **wrath has come up them**: (1) completely or totally. In this case, God reveals all of his **wrath**, not just some of it. Alternate translation: [totally] or [fully]; (2) at a specific moment at the end of a period of time. In this case, the unbelieving Jews are sinning until God finally reveals his **wrath**. Alternate translation: [finally] or [at last]; (3) at the end of this world. In this case, the **end** refers to when Jesus comes back. Alternate translation: [at the end of this world] or [when Jesus returns]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#9)

ἔφθασεν & ἐπ' αὐτοὺς ἡ ὀργὴ

"the wrath has come upon them"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wrath**, you could express the same idea in another way. See how you translated this word in 1:10. Alternate translation: [God has punished them] or [they have been punished]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 2:16 (#7)

ἔφθασεν & ἐπ' αὐτοὺς ἡ ὀργὴ

"the wrath has come upon them"

Here Paul could be using the past tense phrase **has come upon them** to indicate that: (1) the **wrath** will **come** in the future. In this case, Paul uses the past tense to indicate that the **wrath** is certain or will be revealed soon. Alternate translation: [the wrath will certainly come upon them] or [the wrath will soon come upon them]; (2) **wrath** has already **come** when Paul wrote this letter. In this case, at the time Paul wrote this letter, the unbelieving Jews were already experiencing the **wrath**. Alternate translation: [the wrath has already come upon them]; (3) God had already revealed the **wrath** would eventually **come**. In this case, people already know about the **wrath** but will experience it in the future. Alternate translation: [it has already been revealed that the wrath will come upon them]

See: Predictive Past

1 Thessalonians 2:17 (#1)

δέ

"But"

Here, the word **But** introduces how Paul and his fellow workers act in contrast to the people that Paul has described in the previous verses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a contrast. Alternate translation: [On the other hand,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Thessalonians 2:17 (#5)

προσώπῳ οὐ καρδίᾳ

"by face, not by heart"

Here, the word **face** represents physical presence, and the word **heart** represents thoughts and desires. Paul means that he and his fellow workers thought and cared about the Thessalonians (**by heart**) even though they were not physically present in Thessalonica (**by face**). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by physical presence, not by feelings] or [in person, not in affection]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 2:17 (#3)

ἀπορφανισθέντες

"having been separated"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, Acts 17:1–10 shows that people who opposed Paul did it. Alternate translation: [opponents having separated us] or [persecution having separated us]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 2:17 (#7)

τὸ πρόσωπον ὑμῶν ἰδεῖν

"to see your face"

The phrase **to see your face** refers to visiting someone and being with them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to visit you] or [to spend time with you]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 2:17 (#6)

περισσοτέρως ἐσπουδάσαμεν τὸ πρόσωπον ὑμῶν ἰδεῖν ἐν πολλῇ ἐπιθυμίᾳ

“became extremely eager to see your face, in much desire”

The terms **extremely eager** and **in much desire** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [greatly desired to see your face] or [became filled with much eagerness to see your face]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 2:17 (#8)

ἐν πολλῇ ἐπιθυμίᾳ

“in much desire”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desire**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [which we greatly desire] or [for which we yearn]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 2:17 (#4)

πρὸς καιρὸν ὥρας

“for the time of an hour”

Here, the phrase **for the time of an hour** refers to a short span of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar phrase or plain language. Alternate translation: [for a short time]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 2:17 (#2)

ἀπορφανισθέντες ἀφ’ ὑμῶν

“having been separated from you”

Here Paul refers to how he and his fellow workers had to leave the Thessalonians soon after arriving in their city and preaching the good news to them. You can read about this in Acts 17:1–10. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [having been forced to leave you] or [having had to go away from you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:18 (#3)

ἐγὼ μὲν Παῦλος, καὶ ἅπαξ καὶ δίς

“indeed I, Paul, both once and twice”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [indeed I, Paul, desired to come to you both once and twice]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 2:18 (#1)

διότι

“For”

Here, the word **For** could introduce: (1) the basis or evidence for Paul’s claim in the previous verse that he and his fellow workers were eager to visit the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [In fact,] or [You know that is true because]; (2) an inference from Paul’s claim in the previous verse about how eager he and his fellow workers were to visit the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [Therefore,] or [So then,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 2:18 (#4)

καὶ ἅπαξ καὶ δίς

“both once and twice”

Here, the phrase **both once and twice** could mean that: (1) Paul tried to visit the Thessalonians multiple times. In this case, Paul does not clarify how many times he tried. Alternate translation: [many times]; (2) Paul tried to visit them twice. Alternate translation: [two times] or [twice]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 2:18 (#5)

ἐνέκοψεν ἡμᾶς

“hindered us”

Here Paul means that Satan prevented him and his fellow workers from visiting the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [prevented us from doing so] or [made it impossible for us to come]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:18 (#2)

ἐλθεῖν

“to come”

Your language may say “go” rather than **come** in contexts such as this. Alternate translation: [to go]

See: Go and Come

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#4)

στέφανος καυχήσεως

“crown of boasting”

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **crown** that enables or causes **boasting**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [crown about which we boast]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#8)

ἢ

“Or”

Here, the word **Or** introduces the correct answer to the question that Paul asked in the first half of the verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a correct answer, or you could leave **Or** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Indeed,] or [In fact,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#1)

τίς γὰρ ἡμῶν ἐλπὶς ἢ χαρὰ ἢ στέφανος καυχήσεως? ἢ οὐχὶ καὶ ὑμεῖς, ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ, ἐν τῇ αὐτοῦ παρουσίᾳ

“For what {is} our hope or joy or crown of boasting? Or {is it} not also you before our Lord Jesus at his coming”

Paul is using the question form to show the Thessalonians how much he and his fellow workers value and care about them. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate these questions as statements or exclamations. Alternate translation: [For here is our hope and joy and crown of boasting: it is also you before our Lord Jesus at his coming!] or [For you are our hope and joy and crown of boasting before our Lord Jesus at his coming.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#5)

στέφανος καυχήσεως

“crown of boasting”

Here, Paul speaks of the honor and recognition that someone receives for accomplishing a task or goal as if it were a **crown**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [reward about which we boast] or [honor about which we boast]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#6)

καυχήσεως

“of boasting”

Here, many ancient manuscripts read **of boasting**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “of great joy.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#7)

καυχήσεως? ἢ οὐχὶ καὶ ὑμεῖς, ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ, ἐν τῇ αὐτοῦ παρουσίᾳ

“of boasting? Or {is it} not also you before our Lord Jesus at his coming”

Here, the phrase **Or {is it} not even you** could: (1) introduce a second question that answers the first question. Paul is saying that the Thessalonians will be their **hope**, **joy**, and **crown** at Jesus’ coming. Alternate translation: [of boasting? In fact, is it not also you who are these things before our Lord Jesus at his coming?]; (2) be a second question that answers the longer question that the phrase interrupts. In this case, you could use a form that marks the phrase as an interruption, or you could move it to the end of the verse. Alternate translation: [of boasting—is it not also you?—before our Lord Jesus at his coming?] or [of boasting before our Lord Jesus at his coming? Is it not also you?]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#2)

τίς & ἡμῶν ἐλπὶς ἢ χαρὰ ἢ στέφανος καυχήσεως

“what {is} our hope or joy or crown of boasting”

In the next question, Paul identifies the **hope**, **joy**, and **crown** as the Thessalonians themselves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this question so that Paul is asking about people instead of things. Alternate translation: [who gives us hope and joy and a crown of boasting]

See: Personification

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#9)

ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ

"before our Lord Jesus"

Here, the phrase **before our Lord Jesus** implies that Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians will be examined by **the Lord Jesus**. Paul is confident that Jesus will approve of the Thessalonians, which will give Paul and his fellow workers honor and joy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [before our Lord Jesus when he examines everyone] or [when we all are judged by the Lord Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#11)

ἐν τῇ αὐτοῦ παρουσίᾳ

"at his coming"

Here, the phrase **his coming** refers to the specific time in the future when Jesus will come back to earth, judge everyone, punish unbelievers, and reward believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [when he comes back to earth] or [at his return to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#10)

ἡμῶν

"our"

Here, the word **our** includes Paul, Silvanus, Timothy, the Thessalonians, and all believers. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 2:19 (#3)

τίς & ἡμῶν ἐλπὶς ἢ χαρὰ ἢ στέφανος καυχήσεως

"what {is} our hope or joy or crown of boasting"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **hope** and **joy**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [what makes us hopeful or joyful or gives us a crown of boasting]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 2:20 (#1)

γάρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** could introduce: (1) a restatement of the point that Paul made in the previous verse (See: 2:19). Alternate translation: [Yes,]; (2) the basis for the point that Paul made in the previous verse (See: 2:19). Alternate translation: [That is because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 2:20 (#2)

ἐστε ἡ δόξα ἡμῶν, καὶ ἡ χαρά

"are our glory and joy"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **glory** and **joy**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [cause us to feel glorious and joyful] or [glorify us and make us happy]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Timothy's visit and good news (3:1–10)
2. A benediction (3:11–13)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Timothy's return to Paul

After Paul, Timothy, and Silvanus left Thessalonica, they visited a city named Berea. Then, they visited a city named Athens. In 3:1, Paul mentions that he and Silvanus stayed in Athens and sent Timothy to visit the Thessalonians. Eventually, Paul left Athens and went to Corinth. While he was in Corinth, Timothy returned from visiting the Thessalonians (see Acts 18:1–5). In this chapter, Paul explains how happy he and his fellow workers became when they heard good news from Timothy about the Thessalonians. In fact, Timothy's return to Paul is the reason why Paul wrote this letter.

Afflictions

Throughout this chapter, Paul refers to how he, his fellow workers, and other believers (including the Thessalonians) are or will experience afflictions. When Paul and his fellow workers visited Thessalonica and a nearby town named Berea, some other Jewish people tried to hurt them and have them arrested. These people also persecuted anyone who believed the gospel. You can read about these afflictions in Acts 17:1–15.

Make sure that your translation clearly indicates this kind of persecution.

Paul's prayer
In 3:11–13, Paul includes a prayer that God would enable him and his fellow workers to visit the Thessalonians and that God would strengthen and bless the Thessalonians. Paul refers to God in the third person in this prayer, which was a common practice for this kind of prayer. Consider how you might include a prayer to God within a letter in your culture.

1 Thessalonians 3:1 (#3)

στέγοντες

"enduring {it"

Here, the word **enduring** could introduce: (1) the reason why Paul and his fellow workers **thought it good to be left behind**. Alternate translation: [since we could endure it]; (2) the time when Paul and his fellow workers **thought it good to be left behind**. Alternate translation: [when we could endure it]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:1 (#6)

Ἀθήναις

"Athens"

The word **Athens** is the name of a city. It was one of the most important cities in the country we call Greece.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Thessalonians 3:1 (#1)

διὸ

"Therefore"

Here, the word **Therefore** introduces an inference or result based on what Paul said in the previous verses about how he and his fellow workers desired to visit the Thessalonians (see 2:17–20). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an inference or result. Alternate translation: [As a result of that] or [Because of that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:1 (#2)

μηκέτι στέγοντες

"enduring {it} no longer"

Here Paul implies that he and his fellow workers could no longer endure being separated from the Thessalonians and longing to see them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [enduring our separation from you no longer] or [no longer enduring how we long to see you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:1 (#5)

καταλειφθῆναι

"to be left behind"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to remain] or [to have everyone else leave us behind]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 3:1 (#4)

μηκέτι στέγοντες, ηὐδοκήσαμεν καταλειφθῆναι

"enduring {it} no longer, we thought it good to be left behind"

Here Paul could be saying that: (1) Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy could endure no longer and together decided that Paul and Silvanus should stay in Athens. Alternate translation: [enduring it no longer, Silvanus, Timothy, and I thought it good that Silvanus and I should be left behind]; (2) Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy could endure no longer and together decided that Paul should stay in Athens by himself. Alternate translation: [enduring it no longer, Silvanus, Timothy, and I though it good that I should be left behind]; (3) only Paul could endure no longer and himself decided that he should stay in Athens by himself. In this case, Paul uses the plural form to refer to himself only. Alternate translation: [enduring it no longer, I thought it good that I should be left behind]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#3)

τὸν ἀδελφὸν ἡμῶν

"our brother"

Paul is using the term **brother** to mean a person who shares the same faith with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [our believing friend]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#5)

διάκονον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“a servant of God”

Many ancient manuscripts read **a servant of God**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “a fellow worker of God.” Other ancient manuscripts read “fellow worker.” Other manuscripts read “a servant of God and our fellow worker.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#1)

ἐπέμψαμεν Τιμόθεον & ἡμῶν

“we sent Timothy, our”

Here, the words **we** and **our** do not include the Thessalonians. Make sure that your translation fits with how you chose to translate “we” in the previous verse. In this verse, the words **we** and **our** could refer to: (1) Paul and Silvanus. Alternate translation: [Silvanus and I sent Timothy, our]; (2) just Paul. Alternate translation: [I sent Timothy, my]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#8)

τὸ στηρίξαι

“strengthen”

Here, Paul is speaking of Timothy supporting or helping the Thessalonians in their faith as if he were making them physically stronger. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [help]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#4)

διάκονον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“a servant of God”

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **servant** who could: (1) serve **God**. Alternate translation: [one who serves God]; (2) serve other people for God’s sake. Alternate translation: [one who serves others for God’s sake]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#2)

ἐπέμψαμεν Τιμόθεον

“we sent Timothy”

Here Paul implies that he and Silvanus **sent Timothy** to visit the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [we sent Timothy to you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#7)

τῷ εὐαγγελίῳ τοῦ Χριστοῦ

“the gospel of Christ”

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **gospel** that could be: (1) about **Christ**. Alternate translation: [the gospel about Christ]; (2) be from **Christ**. Alternate translation: [the gospel from Christ]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#6)

ἐν

“in”

The preposition **in** could refer to: (1) how Timothy works to preach the gospel. Alternate translation: [in preaching]; (2) the means by which Timothy serves. Alternate translation: [by means of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:2 (#9)

τῆς πίστεως ὑμῶν

“your faith”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how you believe]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:3 (#6)

εἰς τοῦτο

“for this”

The pronoun **this** refers to experiencing the **afflictions** that Paul has mentioned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could refer to the **afflictions** more explicitly. Alternate translation: [for suffering these afflictions]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 3:3 (#4)

γὰρ

“For”

Here, the word **For** introduces an explanation for why the Thessalonians should not **be disturbed**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an explanation for a claim. Alternate translation: [Indeed,] or [You should not be disturbed because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 3:3 (#8)

κείμεθα

"we are appointed"

By **we**, Paul includes himself, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians, so use the inclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 3:3 (#7)

κείμεθα

"we are appointed"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, it is clear from the context that it was God. Alternate translation: [God has appointed us]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 3:3 (#1)

τὸ μηδένα σαίνεσθαι

"that no one be disturbed"

Here, the word **that** could introduce: (1) another purpose for which Paul sent Timothy to the Thessalonians to strengthen and comfort them (see 3:2). Alternate translation: [in order that no one would be disturbed]; (2) what Timothy strengthened and comforted the Thessalonians about. Alternate translation: [showing you that no one should be disturbed] or [that is, that no one be disturbed]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:3 (#2)

μηδένα σαίνεσθαι ἐν ταῖς θλίψεσιν ταύταις

"no one be disturbed by these afflictions"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [these afflictions disturb no one]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 3:3 (#3)

ἐν ταῖς θλίψεσιν ταύταις

"by these afflictions"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **afflictions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by being afflicted] or [by how we are afflicted]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:3 (#5)

αὐτοὶ & οἴδατε

"you yourselves know"

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun **you**, which is already implied in the verb **know**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **yourselves**. Alternate translation: [as for you, you know] or [it is you who know]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 3:4 (#3)

προελέγομεν ὑμῖν ὅτι μέλλομεν θλίβεσθαι, καθὼς

"we were telling you in advance that we are about to be afflicted, just as"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [we were telling you in advance, "We are about to be afflicted," just as]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Thessalonians 3:4 (#5)

ἐγένετο καὶ οἴδατε

"it happened and you know"

Here Paul means that what he and his fellow workers told the Thessalonians would happen did indeed happen, and the Thessalonians know it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make it more explicit that the Thessalonians **know** that the afflictions **happened**. Alternate translation: [it happened, which you know]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:4 (#1)

καὶ γὰρ

“For also”

Here, the phrase **For also** introduces another reason why the Thessalonians should “not be disturbed by these afflictions” (see 3:3). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces another reason for a claim. Alternate translation: [Another reason why you should not be disturbed is that] or [Further,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:4 (#4)

μέλλομεν θλίβεσθαι

“we are about to be afflicted”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, you could use an indefinite subject. Alternate translation: [people are about to afflict us]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 3:4 (#2)

πρὸς ὑμᾶς ἦμεν, προελέγομεν ὑμῖν ὅτι μέλλομεν

“we were with you, we were telling you in advance that we are about”

Here, the word **we** in the clauses **we were with you** and **we were telling you** only includes Paul and his fellow workers. It does not include the Thessalonians. However, the word **we** in the clause **we are about to suffer affliction** does include the Thessalonians. Make sure that this is clear if your language marks these distinctions.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#2)

μηκέτι στέγων

“no longer enduring {it”

Here, much as in 3:1, the word **enduring** could introduce: (1) the reason why Paul **sent** Timothy. Alternate translation: [since I could no longer endure it]; (2) the time when Paul **sent** Timothy. Alternate translation: [when I could no longer endure it]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#3)

μηκέτι στέγων

“no longer enduring {it”

Here, much as in 3:1 Paul implies that he could no longer endure being separated from the Thessalonians and not knowing how they were doing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [enduring my separation from you no longer] or [no longer enduring how I long to see you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#8)

ἐπείρασεν ὑμᾶς

“had tempted you”

Here Paul implies that he was worried not only that they would be **tempted** but also that they would stop believing when they were tempted. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [had somehow successfully tempted you] or [had tempted you with the result that you stopped believing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#6)

μή πως

“lest somehow”

Here, the phrase **lest somehow** introduces something that Paul was worried about. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [fearing that somehow] or [worrying that somehow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#7)

ὁ πειράζων

“the tempter”

Here Paul uses the phrase **the tempter** to refer to the devil, Satan. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [the tempter, Satan,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο κἀγὼ μηκέτι στέγων, ἔπεμψα

“Because of this, I also, no longer enduring {it}, sent”

Here, the word **this** could refer to: (1) what Paul said in the previous verse about how the believers have experienced affliction (See: 3:4). Alternate translation: [Because of those afflictions, I also, no longer enduring it, sent]; (2) what Paul says in this verse about how he could no longer endure. Alternate translation: [Because I could no longer endure it, I also sent]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#9)

ὁ κόπος ἡμῶν

“our labor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **labor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what we had done among you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#5)

τὴν πίστιν ὑμῶν

“your faith”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [whether you continue to believe]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#4)

ἔπεμψα

“sent”

Here Paul implies that he **sent** Timothy to the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [sent Timothy to you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:5 (#10)

εἰς κενὸν

“in vain”

Here, the phrase **in vain** identifies a cause that does not have its intended effect. In this case, Paul’s **labor** will not help the Thessalonians if the tempter successfully tempts them. If it would be helpful in your language, you use a word or phrase that identifies a cause that does not have its intended effect. Alternate translation: [for nothing] or [to no purpose]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 3:6 (#2)

ἄρτι

“just now”

Here, the phrase **just now** introduces the event that prompted Paul to write this letter, 1 Thessalonians. When Paul writes that Timothy returned **just now**, he is referring to the time immediately before he began writing this letter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces something that happened right before a person starts speaking about it. Alternate translation: [just before I started writing this letter,] or [a short while ago,]

See: Connect — Background Information

1 Thessalonians 3:6 (#4)

τὴν πίστιν καὶ τὴν ἀγάπην ὑμῶν

“your faith and love”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **faith** and **love**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Paul implies that the **faith** is in God and **love** is for other people. Alternate translation: [that you continue to believe in God and love other people]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:6 (#6)

ἐπιποθοῦντες

“longing”

Here, the word **longing** could introduce: (1) another thing that the Thessalonians do. If you use the following alternate translation, you should delete the comma before **longing**. Alternate translation: [and that you long]; (2) a result of the kind of **memory** that the Thessalonians have. Alternate translation: [so that you long]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:6 (#3)

πρὸς ἡμᾶς & ἡμῖν & ἡμῶν & ἡμᾶς & ἡμεῖς

“to us & us & of us & us & we”

Every time the words **us** or **we** appear in this verse, they include Paul and Silvanus, but they do not include Timothy or the Thessalonians, so use the exclusive

form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 3:6 (#5)

ἔχετε μνείαν ἡμῶν ἀγαθὴν πάντοτε

"you always have good memory of us"

Here, the clause **you always have good memory of us** indicates that the Thessalonians remembered Paul and his fellow workers as people whom they liked and would want to meet again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable clause or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you always have pleasant memories about us] or [you always remember us fondly]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 3:6 (#1)

δὲ

"But"

Here, the word **But** introduces what actually happened in contrast to what Paul was worried about. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that contrasts a concern with what actually happened. Alternate translation: [Despite my fears,] or [But here is what really happened:]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:6 (#7)

καὶ ἡμεῖς ὑμᾶς

"we also, you"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [we also long to see you]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 3:7 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο

"Because of this"

Here, the word **this** refers to what Paul said in the previous verse about what Timothy reported about the Thessalonians' faith, love, and good memory of Paul and his fellow workers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [Because of this good news] or [Because of what Timothy told us]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 3:7 (#3)

ἐφ' ὑμῖν

"about you"

Here, the phrase translated **about you** could identify: (1) what Paul and his fellow workers are **encouraged** about. Alternate translation: [concerning you]; (2) the reason why Paul and his fellow workers are **encouraged**. Alternate translation: [because of you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:7 (#4)

ἐπὶ πάσῃ τῇ ἀνάγκῃ καὶ θλίψει ἡμῶν

"in all our distress and affliction"

The terms **distress** and **affliction** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [in all our affliction] or [in all our troubles]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 3:7 (#2)

παρεκλήθημεν

"we were encouraged"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, it is clear from the context that it was God. Alternate translation: [we felt encouragement] or [God encouraged us]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 3:7 (#5)

ἐπὶ πάσῃ τῇ ἀνάγκῃ καὶ θλίψει ἡμῶν, διὰ τῆς ὑμῶν πίστεως

"in all our distress and affliction, through your faith"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **distress**, **affliction**, and **faith**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [whenever we were distressed and afflicted, through how you believe]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:8 (#7)

ὑμεῖς στήκετε

“you yourselves stand firm”

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun **you**, which is already implied in the verb **stand**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **yourselves**. Alternate translation: [you indeed stand firm] or [it is you who stand firm]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 3:8 (#5)

ἐὰν

“if”

Paul is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Paul is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

1 Thessalonians 3:8 (#1)

ὅτι

“For”

Here, the word **For** introduces a reason why what Paul said in the previous verse about being encouraged is true (See: 3:7). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason or basis for a previous claim. Alternate translation: [That is because] or [That happened because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:8 (#4)

ζῶμεν

“we live”

Here, the phrase **we live** means that Paul and his fellow workers are refreshed and able to enjoy their lives. Paul does not mean that they were dead or about to die and are now alive again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [we can really live] or [we are refreshed]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 3:8 (#6)

ὑμεῖς στήκετε ἐν Κυρίῳ

“you yourselves stand firm in the Lord”

Here, the phrase **stand firm in** indicates that people are remaining faithful to whomever they are **in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you yourselves remain faithful to the Lord] or [you yourselves persist in trusting the Lord]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 3:8 (#3)

νῦν

“now”

Here, the word **now** could refer to: (1) the time when Paul and his fellow workers **live**. Alternate translation: [presently] or [at this moment]; (2) the result of how the Thessalonians **stand firm**. Alternate translation: [as a result] or [then]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:8 (#2)

νῦν ζῶμεν, ἐὰν ὑμεῖς στήκετε ἐν Κυρίῳ

“now we live, if you yourselves stand firm in the Lord”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the basis for the first phrase. Alternate translation: [if you yourselves stand firm in the Lord, now we live]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:9 (#3)

τίνα & εὐχαριστίαν δυνάμεθα τῷ Θεῷ ἀνταποδοῦναι

“what thanks are we able to give back to God”

Here Paul speaks as if he and his fellow workers owe God a debt that they can pay back by giving **thanks**. He means that the appropriate response to God’s work among the Thessalonians is to give thanks to God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [how can we be thankful enough to God] or [what kind of thanksgiving could we give to God]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 3:9 (#5)

ἐπὶ πάσῃ τῇ χαρᾷ ᾗ χαίρομεν

“for all the joy with which we rejoice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **joy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for how joyfully we rejoice]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:9 (#4)

τῷ Θεῷ & τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν

“to God & our God”

Many ancient manuscripts read **to God** and **our God**. The ULT follows that reading. A few ancient manuscripts read “to the Lord” and “our Lord.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 3:9 (#1)

γὰρ

“For”

Here, the word **For** introduces further information about how Paul and his fellow workers responded to the good news about the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces more information, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Indeed,] or [Further,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 3:9 (#2)

δυνάμεθα & χαίρομεν & ἡμῶν

“are we able & we rejoice & our”

Here, the word **we** in the phrases **are we able** and **we rejoice** only includes Paul and his fellow workers. It does not include the Thessalonians. However, the word **our** in the phrase **our God** does include the Thessalonians. Make sure that this is clear if your language marks these distinctions.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 3:9 (#7)

ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν

“before our God”

Here, the phrase **before our God** means that Paul and his fellow workers **rejoice** in God’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [in the presence of our God] or [when we approach God]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 3:9 (#6)

ἐπὶ πάσῃ τῇ χαρᾷ ᾗ χαίρομεν

“for all the joy with which we rejoice”

Here Paul uses both the word **joy** and the word **rejoice** to emphasize how much joy he and his fellow workers have. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [for how greatly we rejoice] or [for how much joy we experience]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 3:9–10 (#1)

τίνα γὰρ εὐχαριστίαν δυνάμεθα τῷ Θεῷ ἀνταποδοῦναι περὶ ὑμῶν, ἐπὶ πάσῃ τῇ χαρᾷ ᾗ χαίρομεν δι’ ὑμᾶς, ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν. νυκτὸς καὶ ἡμέρας, ὑπερἐκπερισσοῦ δεόμενοι εἰς τὸ ἰδεῖν ὑμῶν τὸ πρόσωπον, καὶ καταρτίσαι τὰ ὑστερήματα τῆς πίστεως ὑμῶν

“For what thanks are we able to give back to God concerning you for all the joy with which we rejoice because of you before our God, night and day pleading earnestly to see your face and to provide what {is} lacking in your faith”

Here Paul is using the question form to show the Thessalonians how thankful he is that they continue to trust God. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this one as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [For we give back to God very many thanks concerning you for all the joy with which we rejoice before our God because of you, night and day pleading earnestly to see your face and to provide what is lacking in your faith!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Thessalonians 3:10 (#2)

ὑπερἐκπερισσοῦ δεόμενοι

“pleading earnestly”

Here Paul implies that he and his fellow workers pray to God when they are **pleading**. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [pleading earnestly with God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:10 (#6)

τῆς πίστεως ὑμῶν

“in your faith”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in what you believe]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:10 (#1)

νυκτὸς καὶ ἡμέρας

“night and day”

Here, the phrase **night and day** indicates that Paul and his fellow workers were **pleading earnestly** during both the day and the night. This means that they were **pleading earnestly** very often every day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the time] or [always]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 3:10 (#4)

ὑμῶν τὸ πρόσωπον

“your face”

Here Paul speaks as if the Thessalonians together had one **face**, but he is referring to each of their faces. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your faces]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:10 (#3)

εἰς τὸ ἰδεῖν ὑμῶν τὸ πρόσωπον

“to see your face”

The phrase **to see your face** refers to visiting someone and being with them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to visit you] or [to spend time with you]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 3:10 (#5)

καταρτίσαι τὰ ὑστερήματα τῆς πίστεως ὑμῶν

“to provide what {is} lacking in your faith”

Here Paul could be implying that the Thessalonians are **lacking**: (1) knowledge about God that should be included in their **faith**. Alternate translation: [to teach you more about your faith]; (2) some aspects of **faith** in God. Alternate translation: [to enable you to have faith completely]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:11 (#3)

ὁ Θεὸς καὶ Πατὴρ ἡμῶν

“our God and Father”

Here, the phrase **our God and Father** refers to the one divine person who is both God and Father. The word **God** and the word **Father** refer to the same person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. See how you translated the similar phrase in 1:3. Alternate translation: [God our Father] or [our Father God]

See: Hendiadys

1 Thessalonians 3:11 (#5)

ἡμῶν & ἡμῶν & ἡμῶν

“our & our & our”

Here, the word **our** in the phrases **our God** and **our Lord** includes all believers. The word **our** in the phrase **our way** only includes Paul and his fellow workers. It does not include the Thessalonians. Make sure that this is clear if your language marks these distinctions.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 3:11 (#1)

δὲ

“But”

Here, the word **But** introduces a new topic. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a new topic, or you could leave **But** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Now]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 3:11 (#4)

αὐτὸς & ὁ Θεὸς καὶ Πατὴρ ἡμῶν

“our God and Father himself”

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun "he," which is already implied in the phrase **our God and Father**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **himself**. Alternate translation: [he who is our God and Father] or [God our Father indeed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 3:11 (#2)

αὐτὸς & ὁ Θεὸς καὶ Πατὴρ ἡμῶν, καὶ ὁ Κύριος ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦς, κατευθύναι τὴν ὁδὸν ἡμῶν πρὸς ὑμᾶς

"may our God and Father himself and our Lord Jesus direct our way to you"

Paul speaks about God the Father and the Lord Jesus as if they were directing Paul's way and his fellow worker's ways. He could mean that God the Father and the Lord Jesus: (1) are like guides who take Paul and his fellow workers to meet the Thessalonians, which would enable Paul and his fellow workers to visit the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [may our God and Father himself and our Lord Jesus bring us to you]; (2) enable Paul and his fellow workers to overcome obstacles that prevent them from visiting the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [may our God and Father himself and our Lord Jesus remove everything that prevents us from visiting you]; (3) lead Paul and his fellow workers on a straight path to the Thessalonians, which would enable Paul and his fellow workers to visit the Thessalonians soon. Alternate translation: [may our God and Father himself and our Lord Jesus enable us to visit you soon]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 3:11–13 (#1)

αὐτὸς δὲ ὁ Θεὸς καὶ Πατὴρ ἡμῶν, καὶ ὁ Κύριος ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦς, κατευθύναι τὴν ὁδὸν ἡμῶν πρὸς ὑμᾶς. ὑμᾶς δὲ ὁ Κύριος πλεονάσαι καὶ περισσεύσαι τῇ ἀγάπῃ εἰς ἀλλήλους, καὶ εἰς πάντας, καθάπερ καὶ ἡμεῖς εἰς ὑμᾶς; εἰς τὸ στηρίξαι ὑμῶν τὰς καρδίας, ἀμέμπτους ἐν ἁγιωσύνῃ ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ Πατρὸς ἡμῶν, ἐν τῇ παρουσίᾳ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ, μετὰ πάντων τῶν ἁγίων αὐτοῦ. ἀμήν

"But may our God and Father himself and our Lord Jesus direct our way to you. Now may the Lord make you increase and abound in love for one another and for all, just as we also toward you, to strengthen your hearts, blameless in holiness before our God and Father, at the coming of our Lord Jesus with all his saints. Amen"

Here Paul is asking God to bless the Thessalonians. You could express this as either a blessing or a prayer, in whichever way is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But we ask our God and Father himself and our Lord Jesus to direct our way to you. We ask the Lord to make you increase and abound in love for one another and for all, just as we also toward you, to strengthen your hearts, blameless in holiness before our God and Father, at the coming of our Lord Jesus with all his saints. Amen!]

See: Blessings

1 Thessalonians 3:12 (#4)

εἰς πάντας

"for all"

Paul is using the adjective **all** as a noun to refer to all people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [for all humans]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Thessalonians 3:12 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Here, the word **Now** introduces the next part of Paul's prayer. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces another section, or you could leave **Now** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Further,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 3:12 (#5)

καὶ ἡμεῖς εἰς ὑμᾶς

"we also toward you"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [we also increase and abound in love for you]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 3:12 (#2)

ὑμᾶς & ὁ Κύριος πλεονάσαι καὶ περισσεύσαι

“may the Lord make you increase and abound”

The terms **increase** and **abound** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [may the Lord make you very much abound] or [may the Lord make you increase greatly]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 3:12 (#3)

τῇ ἀγάπῃ εἰς ἀλλήλους, καὶ εἰς πάντας, καθάπερ καὶ ἡμεῖς εἰς ὑμᾶς

“in love for one another and for all, just as we also toward you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **love**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in how you love one another and all, just as we also love you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#6)

τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ Πατρὸς ἡμῶν

“our God and Father”

Here, the phrase **our God and Father** refers to the one divine person who is both God and Father. The word **God** and the word **Father** refer to the same person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. See how you translated the similar phrase in 3:11. Alternate translation: [God our Father] or [our Father God]

See: Hendiadys

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#8)

ἐν τῇ παρουσίᾳ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ

“at the coming of our Lord Jesus”

Here, the phrase **the coming of our Lord Jesus** refers to the specific time in the future when Jesus will come back to earth, judge everyone, punish unbelievers, and reward believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [when our Lord Jesus comes back to earth] or [at return of our Lord Jesus to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#1)

εἰς τὸ στηρίξαι

“to strengthen”

Here the phrase **to strengthen** introduces the purpose for which Paul prays that the Lord will make the Thessalonians increase in love (see 3:12). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that he might strengthen] or [and I pray those things so that he might strengthen]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#9)

μετὰ πάντων τῶν ἁγίων αὐτοῦ

“with all his saints”

Here, the word **saints** could refer to: (1) believers. Alternate translation: [with everyone who believes in him]; (2) believers and angels. Alternate translation: [with all his holy angels and those who believe in him]; (3) angels. Alternate translation: [with all his holy angels]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#3)

ὑμῶν τὰς καρδίας, ἀμέμπτους

“your hearts, blameless”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply words such as “so that they will be” if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [your hearts so that they will be blameless] or [your hearts so that you will be blameless]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#7)

ἡμῶν

“our”

In both places, the word **our** includes Paul, Silvanus, Timothy, the Thessalonians, and all believers. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#5)

ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ Πατρὸς ἡμῶν

“before our God and Father”

Here, the phrase **before our God and Father** refers to being in the presence of **our God and Father**. In this case, the phrase emphasizes that God is the one who will declare the Thessalonians to be **blameless**

in holiness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [in the presence of our God and Father] or [according to our God and Father]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#2)

εἰς τὸ στηρίξαι ὑμῶν τὰς καρδίας

"to strengthen your hearts"

Here Paul speaks of the Thessalonians becoming spiritually stronger as if their **hearts** were being strengthened. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to strengthen you spiritually] or [to make you stronger on the inside]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 3:13 (#4)

ἐν ἁγιωσύνῃ

"in holiness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **holiness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in how holy you are]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Teaching on sexual morality (4:1–8)
2. Teaching on Christian love (4:9–12)
3. Teaching on the day of the Lord (4:13–5:11)

- Dead believers and the day of the Lord (4:13–18)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Sexual morality

In 4:3–8, Paul commands the Thessalonians to act in holy ways, particularly in relation to their sexual behavior. He does not provide specific details, but he does require them to exercise self-control and to avoid hurting a fellow believer. In the Thessalonians' culture, sexual immorality was very common. Men and women would have sex with people who were not their own spouses, and older men would have sex with younger men. If a Christian had sex with another Christian to whom he or she was not married, it could easily hurt or exploit that person or that person's family. Paul wants the Corinthians to completely avoid this possibility.

Brotherly love

In 4:9–12, Paul praises the Corinthians for showing "brotherly love." He means that they love each other as if they were members of the same family. He also encourages them to show this kind of love even more, which includes staying out of other people's private affairs and making sure that they can provide for themselves instead of depending on other people.

Dead believers

The Thessalonians were worried that believers who had died might not experience some of the wonderful things that will happen when Jesus comes back. In 4:13–18, Paul assures them that believers who had died not miss anything when Jesus comes back. In fact, he tells them that believers who have died will meet Jesus first, before everyone who is still alive meets him. He wants them to encourage or comfort each other with this teaching.

The coming of the Lord

In 4:13–18, Paul teaches the Thessalonians about what will happen when Jesus comes back. He describes Jesus' return with powerful language that includes angels, people being lifted up into the sky, and loud sounds. Scholars debate whether Paul described Jesus' return with symbolic language or whether he described specific events that will happen when Jesus comes back. Your translation should express Paul's descriptions as clearly as possible while allowing for both interpretations of his words.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"His own vessel"

In 4:4, Paul urges each Thessalonian to "possess his own vessel in sanctification and honor." Paul could be using the word "vessel" in several different ways. First (1), and most likely, he could be using "vessel" as a euphemism for the sexual organ. In this case, he is urging the Thessalonians to have self-control over their sexual desires the acts. Also, he is addressing men directly but also includes women in his command. Second (2), he could be using "vessel" as a metaphor for the physical body. In this case, he is focusing particularly on the sexual aspect of the physical body, just like in option (1). Third (3), and least likely, Paul could be using "vessel" as a metaphor for a man's wife. In this case, he is urging each Thessalonian man to be sexually faithful to his wife. It is recommended that you follow option (1) or perhaps option (2) since these are the most likely explanations for why Paul uses the word "vessel." (See: Euphemism; and Metaphor)

"The ones sleeping"
In 4:13–15, Paul refers to people who are "sleeping." This was a polite way in his culture to refer to people who had died. Paul does not have any deeper meaning in mind. Consider how, in your culture, you might politely refer to people who had died. (See: Euphemism)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Did Paul think that Jesus would come back before he himself died?
In 4:15 and 4:17, Paul uses the word "we" to include himself among the believers who are alive when Jesus comes back. Some scholars think that this implies that Paul believed or hoped that Jesus would come back before Paul died. However, other scholars think that Paul used the word "we" because he was referring to believers who are alive, and of course he was alive when he wrote this letter. In your translation, you should use an inclusive form of "we" if your language marks that distinction, but you should not include any further clarification.

What is the sequence of events in 4:15–17?
In these verses, Paul describes several events that will occur in sequence. Based on what he says, we can be relatively sure that the following three events will occur in this order: (1) the Lord Jesus will come down from heaven, (2) believers who have died will resurrect and go with the Lord, and (3) believers who are still alive with be taken up to meet the Lord in the air. It is less clear whether the "loud command," the "voice of an archangel" and the "trumpet of God" happen before or during Jesus' descent from heaven. Also, it is not clear whether Jesus and believers go up to heaven or come back to earth, although coming back to earth is slightly more likely. Make sure that your translation clearly presents the three main events in sequence, and if possible, allow for several different interpretations for the other elements.

1 Thessalonians 4:1 (#6)

περιπατεῖν καὶ ἀρέσκειν Θεῷ

"to walk and to please God"

Here, **to walk and to please** expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **please** describes the way in which the Thessalonian church should **walk**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use **and**. Alternate translation: [to walk in a way that is pleasing to God] or [to walk so that you please God]

See: Hendiadys

1 Thessalonians 4:1 (#3)

ἐρωτῶμεν ὑμᾶς καὶ παρακαλοῦμεν

"we ask and encourage you"

The terms **ask** and **encourage** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [we strongly encourage you] or [we urgently ask you]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 4:1 (#5)

περιπατεῖν & περιπατεῖτε

"to walk & you are walking"

Paul speaks of behavior in life as if it were **walking**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See you how you translated the similar phrase in 2:12. Alternate translation: [to act ... you are acting] or [to live your lives ... you are living your lives]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 4:1 (#7)

ἵνα

"that"

Here, the word **that** could introduce: (1) what it is that Paul and his fellow workers **ask and exhort** the Thessalonians to do. Alternate translation: [we ask that]; (2) the purpose for which Paul and his fellow workers **ask and exhort** the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [in order that]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:1 (#2)

λοιπὸν

"finally"

Here, the word **finally** signals to the audience that Paul is starting the last section of his letter. The word does not mean that Paul is about to finish the letter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces the last major part of a letter. Alternate translation: [lastly] or [in this last section]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:1 (#4)

ἐν Κυρίῳ Ἰησοῦ

“in the Lord Jesus”

Here Paul uses the spatial metaphor **in the Lord Jesus** to describe the union of believers with **Jesus**. In this case, being **in the Lord Jesus**, or united to Jesus, could specifically explain: (1) the reason why Paul and his fellow workers **ask and exhort** the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [because of your union with the Lord Jesus]; (2) the authority by which Paul and his fellow workers **ask and exhort** the Thessalonians. Alternate translation: [as those who represent the Lord Jesus]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 4:1 (#8)

περισσεύητε μᾶλλον

“you might abound even more”

Here Paul implies that he and his fellow workers want the Thessalonians to **abound even more** in pleasing God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [you might abound even more in doing what is pleasing to God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:1 (#1)

οὖν

“Therefore”

Here, the word **Therefore** introduces a development in Paul’s argument. He is transitioning from rejoicing about the Thessalonians to instructing them about how to act and what to believe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces this kind of development. Alternate translation: [So] or [Given all that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:2 (#1)

γὰρ

“For”

Here, the word **For** introduces a further explanation of what Paul said in the previous verse about how the Thessalonians received instructions from Paul and his fellow workers (See: 4:1). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an explanation, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Indeed,] or [In fact,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:2 (#2)

ἐδώκαμεν ὑμῖν

“we gave you”

Here Paul refers to what he and his fellow workers told the Thessalonians when they first visited them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [we, when we were with you, gave you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:2 (#3)

διὰ τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

“through the Lord Jesus”

Here, the phrase **through the Lord Jesus** indicates that Paul and his fellow workers said what **the Lord Jesus** wanted them to say. In other words, they spoke with the authority of **the Lord Jesus**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [as we spoke what the Lord Jesus wanted] or [by the authority of the Lord Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:3 (#3)

θέλημα τοῦ Θεοῦ, ὁ ἁγιασμὸς ὑμῶν

“the will of God, your sanctification”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **will** and **sanctification**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [what God wants, that you become holy]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 4:3 (#1)

γάρ

“For”

Here, the word **For** introduces specific examples of the “commands” that Paul and his fellow workers gave to the Thessalonians (See: 4:2). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces specific examples, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Specifically] or [For example, we told you that]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:3 (#5)

ἀπέχεσθαι ὑμᾶς ἀπὸ

“that you keep yourselves from”

Alternate translation: [that you stay away from] or [that you avoid]

1 Thessalonians 4:3 (#4)

ὁ ἁγιασμὸς ὑμῶν, ἀπέχεσθαι ὑμᾶς

“your sanctification: that you keep yourselves”

Here, the phrase **that you keep yourselves** introduces an explanation of what Paul means when he uses the word **sanctification**. This explanation continues in 4:4–6. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an explanation. Alternate translation: [your sanctification, that is, that you keep yourselves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:3 (#2)

τοῦτο & ἐστιν θέλημα τοῦ Θεοῦ, ὁ ἁγιασμὸς ὑμῶν

“this is the will of God, your sanctification”

Here, the word **this** refers to the phrase **your sanctification**. Paul uses this form to emphasize **sanctification**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea in another way that emphasizes **sanctification**. Alternate translation: [your sanctification is the will of God] or [the will of God is your sanctification]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 4:3 (#6)

τῆς πορνείας

“sexual immorality”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **immorality**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [doing what is sexually immoral] or [acting in sexually immoral ways]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 4:4 (#3)

τὸ ἑαυτοῦ σκεῦος, κτᾶσθαι

“to possess his own vessel”

Here, the word **vessel** could refer to: (1) a person’s sexual organ. This is a euphemism. Alternate translation: [to possess his own sexual organ]; (2) a man’s wife. This is a metaphor. Alternate translation: [to possess his own wife]

See: Euphemism

1 Thessalonians 4:4 (#6)

ἐν ἁγιασμῷ καὶ τιμῇ

“in sanctification and honor”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **sanctification** and **honor**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [in holy and honorable ways]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 4:4 (#5)

τὸ ἑαυτοῦ σκεῦος

“his own vessel”

The referent of the word **his** depends on what the word **vessel** means (See: the previous two notes): (1) If the word **vessel** refers to a person’s sexual organ, Paul is using the word **his** in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [his or her own vessel]; (2) If the word **vessel** refers to a wife, Paul is using the word **his** to refer only to men and not to women. Alternate translation: [the vessel that is his]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 4:4 (#2)

εἰδέναι ἕκαστον ὑμῶν & κτᾶσθαι

“that each of you knows to possess”

Here, the word **knows** could refer specifically to: (1) learning how to do something. Alternate translation: [that each of you learns to possess]; (2) understanding something. Alternate translation: [that each of you understands how to possess]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:4 (#1)

εἰδέναι ἕκαστον ὑμῶν

“that each of you knows”

Here, the phrase **that each of you knows** could: (1) give another example of what “sanctification” means (See: 4:3). Alternate translation: [and that each of you knows]; (2) describe more specifically what it means to avoid “sexual immorality” (See: 4:3). Alternate translation: [more specifically, that each of you knows]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:4 (#4)

τὸ ἑαυτοῦ σκεῦος, κτᾶσθαι

"to possess his own vessel"

The meaning of the verb **possess** depends on what the word **vessel** means (See: the previous note): (1) If the word **vessel** refers to the body or more specifically to the sexual organ, the word **possess** refers to people having control over their bodies. Alternate translation: [to exercise control over his sexual organs] or [to exercise sexual self-control]; (2) If the word **vessel** refers to a wife, the word **possess** could refer to a man having sex with his wife. Alternate translation: [to have sexual relations with his wife]; (3) If the word **vessel** refers to a wife, the word **possess** could refer to a man marrying a woman. Alternate translation: [to marry a wife]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 4:5 (#4)

καθάπερ καὶ τὰ ἔθνη τὰ μὴ εἰδότα τὸν Θεόν

"just as also the Gentiles, the ones not knowing God"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply words such as "behave" or "act" if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [just as also the Gentiles behave, the ones not knowing God] or [just as also the Gentiles, the ones not knowing God, act]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 4:5 (#3)

πάθει ἐπιθυμίας

"the passion of lust"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to connect **passion** and **lust**. More specifically, he could be referring to: (1) **passion** that is characterized by **lust**. Alternate translation: [lustful passion]; (2) **lust** that is characterized by **passion**. Alternate translation: [passionate lust]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 4:5 (#2)

μὴ ἐν πάθει ἐπιθυμίας

"not in the passion of lust"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **passion** and **lust**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [not passionately lusting]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 4:5 (#1)

μὴ ἐν πάθει ἐπιθυμίας

"not in the passion of lust"

Here, **not in the passion of lust** contrasts with the previous phrase "in holiness and honor" (See: 4:4). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces this kind of contrast. Alternate translation: [and in contrast, not in the passion of lust]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:5 (#5)

τὰ ἔθνη τὰ μὴ εἰδότα τὸν Θεόν

"the Gentiles, the ones not knowing God"

Here Paul is distinguishing from **Gentiles** who do not know God from Gentiles who do know God. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [the Gentiles, specifically the ones not knowing God] or [all the Gentiles who do not know God]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 4:5 (#6)

τὰ μὴ εἰδότα τὸν Θεόν

"the ones not knowing God"

Here, the phrase **not knowing God** means that these **Gentiles** do not listen to, trust in, or obey God. It does not mean that they do not know about God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones not listening to God] or [the ones not obeying God]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#1)

τὸ μὴ ὑπερβαίνειν

"not to transgress"

Here, the phrase **not to transgress** could introduce: (1) the purpose of what Paul has said in 4:3–5 about abstaining from sexual immorality. Alternate translation: [in order not to transgress]; (2) another example of what "sanctification" means (See: 4:3). Alternate

translation: [and that each of you does not transgress]; (3) another description of what it means to avoid "sexual immorality" (See: 4:3). Alternate translation: [that each of you does not transgress]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#8)

καθὼς καὶ προείπαμεν ὑμῖν καὶ διεμαρτυράμεθα

"just as we also said before to you and testified"

Here Paul refers to what he and his fellow workers told the Thessalonians when they visited them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [just as we also we also said before to you and testified when we visited you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#3)

τὸν ἀδελφὸν αὐτοῦ

"his brother"

Paul is using the term **brother** to mean a person who shares the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his believing friend]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#2)

ὑπερβαίνειν καὶ πλεονεκτεῖν

"transgress and take advantage of"

The two terms **transgress** and **take advantage of** work together to express a single idea. The phrase **take advantage of** tells how a person might **transgress**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [transgress through taking advantage of] or [transgress, taking advantage of]

See: Hendiadys

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#9)

καὶ προείπαμεν ὑμῖν καὶ διεμαρτυράμεθα

"we also said before to you and testified"

The terms **said before** and **testified** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [we also solemnly warned you before] or [we also already testified to you]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#7)

πάντων τούτων

"all these things"

Here, the phrase **all these things** refers to the sinful sexual behaviors that Paul has mentioned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [all these sexually immoral behaviors] or [every sexual sin]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#6)

διότι

"for"

Here, the word **for** introduces a reason why the Thessalonians should obey God by avoiding sexual immorality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason, or you could leave **for** untranslated. Alternate translation: [and you should behave in these ways because] or [all of which you should do since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#4)

τὸν ἀδελφὸν αὐτοῦ

"his brother"

Here Paul could be using the masculine form **his brother** to refer to: (1) specific fellow believers, whether men or women. Alternate translation: [any brother or sister] or [his or her brother or sister]; (2) specific male believers, specifically men in charge of families. Alternate translation: [any brother in charge of a family]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 4:6 (#5)

ἐν τῷ πράγματι

"in this matter"

Here, the phrase **this matter** refers to what Paul has been speaking about: sexual morality. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [in the area of sexual morality] or [in his sexual behavior]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:7 (#2)

ἡμᾶς

“us”

Here, the word **us** includes Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 4:7 (#3)

ἐπὶ ἀκαθαρσίᾳ, ἀλλ’ ἐν ἁγιασμῷ

“for uncleanness, but in sanctification”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **uncleanness** and **sanctification**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [to be unclean, but to be sanctified] or [to act in unclean ways, but in holy ways]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 4:7 (#4)

ἀλλ’ ἐν ἁγιασμῷ

“but in sanctification”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but he called us in sanctification]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 4:7 (#1)

γὰρ

“For”

Here, the word **For** introduces a reason or basis for what Paul has said about avoiding sexual immorality (See: 4:3–6). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason or basis. Alternate translation: [All that is important because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:8 (#2)

ὁ ἀθετῶν

“the one rejecting”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. Many languages would need to say what it is that is being rejected. If it would be helpful in your language you could refer back to what Paul has commanded the Thessalonians about living holy lives and avoiding sexual immorality. Alternate translation: [the one rejecting these commands about sexual morality] or [the one rejecting what we have said about sexual behavior]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 4:8 (#3)

οὐκ ἄνθρωπον ἀθετεῖ, ἀλλὰ τὸν Θεὸν, τὸν διδόντα

“rejects not man, but God, the one giving”

If your language would not naturally put the negative statement before the positive statement, you could reverse the two elements here. Alternate translation: [rejects God, not man, and God is the one who gives]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 4:8 (#6)

τὸν διδόντα

“the one giving”

Many ancient manuscripts read **the one giving**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “the one having given.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 4:8 (#7)

ὑμᾶς

“you”

Many ancient manuscripts read **you**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “us.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 4:8 (#4)

ἄνθρωπον

“man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [a person] or [a man or woman]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 4:8 (#1)

τοιγαροῦν

"Therefore"

Here, the word **Therefore** introduces an inference or conclusion from what Paul has said in 4:3–7. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use another word that introduces an inference or conclusion. Alternate translation: [Because of all that] or [In conclusion]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:8 (#5)

τὸν διδόντα

"the one giving"

Here Paul is adding more information about **God**. He is not distinguishing between different gods. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that clearly adds information instead of distinguishing between people. Alternate translation: [who is the one who gives]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 4:9 (#4)

οὐ χρείαν ἔχετε γράφειν ὑμῖν, αὐτοὶ γὰρ ὑμεῖς θεοδίδακτοί ἐστε, εἰς τὸ ἀγαπᾶν ἀλλήλους

"you have no need {for us} to write to you, for you yourselves are taught by God to love one another"

If your language would naturally state a reason before its result, you could reverse the order of these clauses. Alternate translation: [because you yourselves are taught by God to love one another, you have no need {for us} to write to you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:9 (#5)

ἔχετε

"you have"

Many ancient manuscripts read **you have**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read "we have." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 4:9 (#3)

τῆς φιλαδελφίας

"brotherly love"

Here Paul uses the phrase **brotherly love** to refer to love for people who share the same faith, both men and women. If possible, use the same form you have used to translate the word "brothers." Alternate translation: [love for believers]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 4:9 (#6)

γὰρ

"for"

Here, the word **for** introduces a reason why Paul and his fellow workers do not need to write to the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason or basis for a claim, or you could leave **for** untranslated. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:9 (#2)

τῆς φιλαδελφίας

"brotherly love"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **love**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [loving the brothers] or [how to love others in a brotherly way]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 4:9 (#8)

αὐτοὶ & ὑμεῖς & ἐστε

"you yourselves are"

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun **you**, which is already implied in the verb **are**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **yourselves**. Alternate translation: [it is you who are] or [as for you, you are]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 4:9 (#7)

αὐτοὶ & ὑμεῖς θεοδίδακτοί ἐστε

“you yourselves are taught by God”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God has taught you yourselves]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 4:9 (#1)

δὲ

“But”

Here, the word **But** introduces a new section in the letter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a new section, or you could leave **But** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Next,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:10 (#2)

ποιεῖτε αὐτὸ

“you do it”

Here, the word **it** refers to “brotherly love” (see 4:9). If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [you show brotherly love]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 4:10 (#1)

καὶ γὰρ ποιεῖτε

“For also you do”

Here, the phrase **For also** introduces another reason why Paul and his fellow workers do not need to write to the Thessalonians (see 4:9). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces another reason or basis for a claim, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Again, we do not need to write to you about this, since you do] or [Even more, you do]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:10 (#4)

περισσεύειν μᾶλλον

“to abound even more”

Here Paul implies that he and his fellow workers want the Thessalonians to **abound** in brotherly love **even more**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [to abound even more in brotherly love]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:10 (#3)

δὲ

“But”

Here, the word **But** introduces a slight contrast between what the Thessalonians are doing and how Paul wants them to do it **even more**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces this kind of contrast, or you could leave **But** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Now] or [Yet]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:11 (#4)

καθὼς ὑμῖν παρηγγείλαμεν

“just as we commanded you”

Here Paul refers to what he and his fellow workers **commanded** the Thessalonians when they visited them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [just as we commanded you when we visited you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:11 (#3)

ἐργάζεσθαι ταῖς ἰδίαις χερσὶν ὑμῶν

“to work with your own hands”

Here Paul uses the phrase **work with your own hands** to indicate that the Thessalonians should support themselves instead of relying on others to provide for them. He does not mean that they must do physical labor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to provide for yourselves] or [to earn your own living]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 4:11 (#1)

ἡσυχάζειν

“to be quiet”

Here, the phrase **to be quiet** refers to living in a peaceful way that does not disrupt others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar

phrase or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to avoid disrupting others] or [to behave calmly around other people]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 4:11 (#2)

πράσσειν τὰ ἴδια

"to perform your own things"

Here, the phrase **to perform your own things** refers to focusing on one's own tasks and responsibilities instead of becoming involved in other people's private affairs. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [to focus on your own affairs] or [to stay out of other people's business]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:12 (#1)

ἵνα

"so that"

Here, the phrase **so that** could introduce: (1) the result of doing what Paul has commanded in 4:10–11. Alternate translation: [with the result that]; (2) the purpose of doing what Paul has commanded in 4:10–11. Alternate translation: [in order that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:12 (#4)

μηδενὸς

"of nothing"

Here word translated **nothing** could refer: (1) to things. In this case, Paul wants them to have everything that they need. Alternate translation: [of no essential things]; (2) to people. In this case, Paul wants them to be independent and not rely on other people to provide for them. Alternate translation: [of nobody] or [of support from no person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:12 (#3)

τοὺς ἔξω

"the ones outside"

Here, the phrase **the ones outside** identifies people who do not belong to the group of believers in Thessalonica. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea with a word or phrase that refers to people who do not belong to a specific group. Alternate translation: [the outsiders] or [the unbelievers]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 4:12 (#2)

περιπατῆτε

"you may walk"

Paul speaks of behavior in life as if it were walking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you may act] or [you may live your lives]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#8)

ἐλπίδα

"hope"

Here Paul implies that the **hope** concerns what happens to people after they die. People who do not have **hope** do not expect anyone who dies to live again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [hope that people will live again] or [hope of resurrection]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#5)

οἱ λοιποὶ, οἱ μὴ ἔχοντες ἐλπίδα

"the rest, the ones not having hope"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the rest grieve, the ones not having hope] or [the rest who have no hope grieve]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#2)

οὐ θέλομεν & ὑμᾶς ἀγνοεῖν

"we do not want you to be ignorant"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **ignorant**. Alternate translation: [we want you to know]

See: Double Negatives

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#3)

τῶν κοιμωμένων

“the ones sleeping”

Here, the phrase **the ones sleeping** is a polite way to refer to people who have died. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar polite phrase or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones having passed away] or [the ones who are dead]

See: Euphemism

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#4)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting words **so that** introduce the purpose for which Paul wants to instruct the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a purpose or goal. Alternate translation: [in order that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Here, the word **Now** introduces a new section in the letter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a new section, or you could leave **Now** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Next,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#7)

οἱ λοιποὶ

“the rest”

Paul is using the adjective **rest** as a noun to refer to a group of people that includes everyone who does not have hope. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the rest of people] or [everyone else]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#9)

οἱ μὴ ἔχοντες ἐλπίδα

“the ones not having hope”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hope**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the ones not hoping] or [the ones not expecting anything]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 4:13 (#6)

οἱ λοιποὶ, οἱ μὴ ἔχοντες ἐλπίδα

“the rest, the ones not having hope”

Here Paul is distinguishing between people who have hope and people who do not have hope. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [the rest who do not have hope] or [the rest, that is, those who do not have hope]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#4)

ἀνέστη

“rose”

Here, the word **rose** refers to how Jesus came back to life after he **died**. If your language does not use **rose** to describe coming back to life, you could use a comparable idiom or express the idea plainly. Alternate translation: [came back to life] or [lived again]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#8)

ἄξει

“will bring”

Here, the phrase **will bring** could mean that: (1) God will send resurrected believers with Jesus when Jesus comes back to this world. Alternate translation: [will send back to earth]; (2) God will bring resurrected believers to be with Jesus in heaven. Alternate translation: [will bring to heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#11)

αὐτῷ

“him”

The pronoun **him** refers to **Jesus**. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the person’s name here. Alternate translation: [with Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#9)

τοὺς κοιμηθέντας

"the ones having slept"

See how you translated the similar phrase in 4:13. Alternate translation: [the ones having passed away] or [the ones who are dead]

See: Euphemism

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#3)

πιστεύομεν

"we believe"

Here, the word **we** includes Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians, so use the inclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#7)

ὁ Θεὸς τοὺς κοιμηθέντας διὰ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ ἄξει σὺν αὐτῷ

"God will bring the ones having slept through Jesus with him"

Here Paul does not explicitly state all the elements in his comparison between **Jesus** and the **the ones having slept**. He states that Jesus **died and rose**, and he implies that this will be true for **the ones having slept**. He states that **the ones having slept** will be brought **with** Jesus, and he implies that Jesus is coming back to this world. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make these two implicit ideas more explicit. Alternate translation: [God will raise the ones having slept through Jesus and will bring them with him when he comes back]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#2)

εἰ

"if"

Paul speaks as if this were a hypothetical situation, but he means that it must be true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Paul is saying is uncertain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#5)

οὕτως καὶ ὁ Θεὸς

"thus also God"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [we believe that thus also God]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces a reason why the Thessalonians should not grieve like other people do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason or basis for a claim, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [You should not grieve in those ways because,] or [Indeed,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#6)

οὕτως καὶ ὁ Θεὸς

"thus also God"

The phrase **thus also** could go with: (1) **God will bring**. In this case, **thus also** indicates that believers will experience something that is similar to how Jesus died and rose again. Alternate translation: [we can also believe that, in a similar way, God]; (2) the implied phrase "we believe." In this case, **thus also** indicates that believing that Christians will resurrect is based on believing in Jesus' resurrection. Alternate translation: [thus also we believe that God]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 4:14 (#10)

ὁ Θεὸς τοὺς κοιμηθέντας διὰ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ ἄξει σὺν αὐτῷ

"God will bring the ones having slept through Jesus with him"

Here, the phrase **through Jesus** could go with: (1) **will bring**. In this case, God acts through **Jesus**. Alternate translation: [through Jesus God will bring with him the ones having slept]; (2) **having slept**. In this case, Paul is describing people who died while they were believing in **Jesus**. Alternate translation: [God will bring with

him the ones having slept in Jesus] or [God will bring with him the believers who have slept]

See: Information Structure

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#10)

τοὺς κοιμηθέντας

"the ones having slept"

See how you translated the similar phrase in 4:13–14. Alternate translation: [the ones having passed away] or [the ones who are dead]

See: Euphemism

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#9)

οὐ μὴ φθάσωμεν

"will certainly not go before"

Here, the phrase **will certainly not go before** indicates that people who are alive when Jesus comes back will not meet him first. Instead, believers who have died will meet him first, and then believers who are alive will meet him. Paul explains this further in the following verse (see 4:16). If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [will certainly not go to Jesus before] or [will certainly not be with Jesus before]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#8)

οὐ μὴ φθάσωμεν

"will certainly not go before"

The words translated **certainly not** are two negative words. In this construction, the second negative does not cancel the first to create a positive meaning. Instead, it gives greater emphasis to the negative. If your language can use two negatives that do not cancel one another to create a positive meaning, you could use a double negative here. If your language does not use two negatives in that way, you could translate with one strong negative, as the ULT does. Alternate translation: [will by no means go before]

See: Double Negatives

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#7)

εἰς τὴν παρουσίαν τοῦ Κυρίου

"to the coming of the Lord"

Here, the phrase **the coming of the Lord** refers to the specific time in the future when Jesus will come back to earth, judge everyone, punish unbelievers, and reward believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. See how you translated the similar phrase in 3:13. Alternate translation: [until when the Lord comes back to earth] or [to the return of our Lord to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces a further explanation of what Paul has said about believers who have died. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a further explanation, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Further,] or [Indeed,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#4)

λόγῳ

"a word"

Paul is using the term **word** to mean a message that is shared by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a message] or [words]

See: Metonymy

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#3)

λέγομεν & ἡμεῖς οἱ ζῶντες

"we say & we, the ones living"

Here, the word **we** in the phrase **we say** only includes Paul and his fellow workers. It does not include the Thessalonians. However, the word **we** in the phrase **we, the ones living** does include the Thessalonians. Make sure that this is clear if your language marks these distinctions.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#5)

λόγῳ Κυρίου

"a word of the Lord"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **word** that could be: (1) something that **the Lord** said. Alternate translation: [a word from the Lord] or [a word spoken by the Lord]; (2) authorized by **the Lord**. Alternate translation: [a word that the Lord approves] or [a word that has the Lord's authority]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#2)

τοῦτο & ὑμῖν λέγομεν ἐν λόγῳ Κυρίου, ὅτι

“this we say to you in a word of the Lord, that”

Here, the word **this** refers to what Paul introduces with the word **that**. This form emphasizes what Paul is about to say. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different form that introduces what a person is about to say. Alternate translation: [we say to you in a word of the Lord that] or [here is what we say to you in a word of the Lord:]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 4:15 (#6)

ἡμεῖς οἱ ζῶντες, οἱ περιλειπόμενοι

“we, the ones living, the ones surviving”

Here, the phrases **the ones living** and **the ones surviving** distinguish **we** from other people. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [we, by which I mean those of us who live, who survive]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#8)

ἐν Χριστῷ

“in Christ”

Here Paul uses the spatial metaphor **in Christ** to describe the union of believers with **Christ**. In this case, being **in Christ**, or united to Christ, indicates that Paul is speaking only about **the dead** who are united to Christ, that is, believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that indicates that Paul is speaking about believers who have died. Alternate translation: [Christians] or [who believed in Christ]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#10)

πρῶτον

“first”

Here, the word **first** indicates that, after Jesus comes down from heaven, **the dead in Christ** will resurrect before anything else happens. Paul indicates in the following verse what happens after they resurrect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [before anything else happens] or [immediately afterwards]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#4)

ἐν κελεύσματι

“with a shout”

Here Paul does not specify who gives the **loud command**. He implies that it is God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [with a loud command from God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#9)

ἀναστήσονται

“will rise”

Here, the word **rise** refers to people who had died then coming back to life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable idiom or express the idea plainly. Alternate translation: [will be restored to life] or [will resurrect]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#6)

καὶ

“and”

Here, the word **and** introduces an event that comes after the previously described events. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase introduces the next event in a sequence. Alternate translation: [and then] or [and after that]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#2)

αὐτὸς ὁ Κύριος

“the Lord himself”

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun “him,” which is already implied in the verbal phrase **will come down**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **himself**. Alternate translation: [it is the Lord who] or [as for the Lord, he]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#1)

ὅτι

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces an elaboration or explanation of what Paul said in the previous verse about how living believers will not "go before" dead believers (see 4:15). This explanation continues in 4:17. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces an elaboration or explanation. Alternate translation: [Here is what I mean:] or [More specifically,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#5)

σάλπιγγι Θεοῦ

"a trumpet of God"

Paul is using the possessive form to describe **a trumpet** that is related to **God**. More specifically, the **trumpet** could: (1) be one that **God** commands to be blown. Alternate translation: [a trumpet that God has someone blow]; (2) belong to **God**. Alternate translation: [God's trumpet]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#7)

οἱ νεκροὶ

"the dead"

Paul is using the adjective **dead** as a noun in order to refer to believers who are **dead**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with a noun phrase. Alternate translation: [the dead people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Thessalonians 4:16 (#3)

ἐν κελεύσματι, ἐν φωνῇ ἀρχαγγέλου, καὶ ἐν σάλπιγγι Θεοῦ

"with a shout, with the voice of an archangel, and with a trumpet of God"

Here Paul provides a list with three items. This list might refer to: (1) three different actions that all make sounds. Alternate translation: [with a loud command, the voice of an archangel, and a trumpet of God]; (2) one action, the **loud command**. This **command** is made up of the **voice of an archangel** and the **trumpet of God**. Alternate translation: [with a loud command given by the voice of an archangel and by a trumpet of God]; (3) two different actions, the **loud command** and the **voice of an archangel**, and the **archangel** uses **a trumpet of God**. Alternate translation: [with a loud command and with the voice of an archangel who uses a trumpet of God]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#5)

αὐτοῖς

"them"

The pronoun **them** refers to "the dead in Christ" who resurrect. Paul mentioned them in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the referent more explicit. Alternate translation: [the resurrected believers] or [the dead who live again]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#7)

εἰς ἀπάντησιν τοῦ Κυρίου εἰς ἀέρα

"to meet the Lord in the air"

Here, the phrase **to meet** refers to going to greet someone. Paul could be implying that, after believers greet him, Jesus: (1) continues to earth with all believers. Alternate translation: [to meet the Lord in the air and return to earth with him]; (2) goes back up to heaven with all believers, either temporarily or eternally. Alternate translation: [to meet the Lord in the air and go back to heaven with him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#4)

ἡμεῖς οἱ ζῶντες, οἱ περιλειπόμενοι

"we, the ones living, the ones surviving"

Here, the phrases **the ones living** and **the ones surviving** distinguish **we** from other people. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. See how you translated the similar phrases in 4:15. Alternate translation: [we, by which I mean those of us who live, who survive]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#2)

ἡμεῖς οἱ ζῶντες, οἱ περιλειπόμενοι ἅμα σὺν αὐτοῖς, ἁρπαγησόμεθα

"we, the ones living, the ones surviving, will be caught up together with them"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, it is clear from the context that it was God. Alternate translation: [God will catch us, the ones living, the ones surviving, up together with them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#6)

ἐν νεφέλαις

"in the clouds"

Here, the phrase **in the clouds** could refer to: (1) the place where believers meet the Lord. In other words, the **clouds** are in the **air**, which is where believers **meet the Lord**. Alternate translation: [up among the clouds]; (2) the means by which believers go to meet the Lord. In this case, the **clouds** are what believers stand on as they go to meet the Lord. Some people in Paul's culture told stories about people standing on clouds as they traveled to heaven. Alternate translation: [on the clouds] or [by means of clouds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#3)

ἡμεῖς & πάντοτε & ἐσόμεθα

"we & we will always be"

By **we** in both clauses, Paul includes himself, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians, so use the inclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#1)

ἔπειτα

"Then"

Here, the word **Then** indicates that what Paul is about to describe will only happen after the events he described in the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that introduces the next event in a sequence. Alternate translation: [Next,] or [Afterward,]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#8)

εἰς ἀέρα

"in the air"

Here, the phrase **in the air** refers to the area above the earth but below heaven, an area often called the sky. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that refers to this area. Alternate translation: [above the earth] or [up in the atmosphere]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:17 (#9)

οὕτως

"in this way"

Here, the phrase **in this way** refers to the process that Paul has outlined in this verse and the previous verse. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces the result of a process. Alternate translation: [as a result] or [after all those events]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 4:18 (#1)

ὥστε

"Therefore"

Here, the word **Therefore** introduces what Paul wants the Thessalonians to do in response to what he has told them about Jesus' second coming and the resurrection of dead believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces the application of a specific teaching. Alternate translation: [So then] or [Now that I have taught you these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 4:18 (#2)

ἐν τοῖς λόγοις τούτοις

"with these words"

Here, the phrase **these words** refers to what Paul has said in 4:13–17. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that refers back to this entire section. Alternate translation: [with all these things that I have taught you] or [with the message I have spoken]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Teaching on the day of the Lord (4:13–5:11)

1 Thessalonians - Chapter 5 Introduction

- The timing of the day of the Lord (5:1–11)

1. Final Commands (5:11–22)
2. Closing (5:23–28)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The timing of the Lord's coming

In 4:13–18, Paul taught the Thessalonians about what will happen to believers who die before Jesus comes back. In 5:1–11, he teaches them about how the timing of Jesus' return should impact how they live now. In these verses, he informs the Thessalonians that Jesus' second coming will surprise people. Scholars debate whether Paul meant that it would surprise everyone or just people who do not believe. Most likely, Paul meant that no one can know for sure when Jesus will return, but believers will be ready for it while unbelievers will not be ready for it. Paul then explains what the Thessalonians should do to be ready for Jesus' return: they should "put on" faith, hope, and love (see 5:8).

The Spirit and prophecies

In 5:19–20, Paul warns the Thessalonians against "quenching" the Holy Spirit and despising prophecies. Most likely, the commands in the next two verses also relate to prophecies (see 5:21–22): the Thessalonians should test all prophecies, hold to those that are right, and avoid those that are wrong. So, Paul wants them to respect all prophecies, since true prophecy comes from the Holy Spirit. However, he also wants them to test prophecies to make sure they really do come from the Holy Spirit. These verses are very short and imply some information, so you may need to make some of these ideas more explicit. See the notes on these verses for translation options.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Thief similes

In 5:2 and 5:4, Paul compares Jesus' second coming to what thieves do and experience. In 5:2, Paul indicates that Jesus' second coming will be surprising, just as a thief breaking into a house is surprising. In 5:4, ancient manuscripts differ in how they express the simile. The reading that the ULT follows indicates that Jesus' second coming will surprise people who are doing what is wrong, just like the daylight surprises thieves who are breaking into a house. The reading that the ULT mentions in a footnote indicates that Jesus' second coming is surprising, just as a thief breaking into a house is surprising. With these similes, Paul compares Jesus' second coming to what thieves do and experience to indicate that Jesus' second coming will surprise people. Make sure that this meaning is clear in your translation. (See: Simile)

Birth pain simile

In 5:3, Paul compares Jesus' second coming to the birth pains that a woman experiences during labor. Just as these birth pains come suddenly and cannot be avoided, so Jesus' second coming will come suddenly, and unbelievers will not be able to escape from Jesus' judgment. Make sure that this meaning is clear in your translation. (See: Simile)

Day and night, light and darkness

Throughout 5:1–11, Paul refers to day and light in contrast to night and darkness. In 5:2 Paul uses the word "day" in the phrase "the day of the Lord." In the following verses, he develops the imagery of day and night so that it connects with the idea of the "day of the Lord." He speaks of people who live in the "day" and in the "light," which figuratively describes people who know that Jesus is coming back and who live properly and obey God. These people will not be surprised or judged on the "day of the Lord," since they are "of day." On the other hand, Paul speaks of people who live in the "night" and in the "darkness," which figuratively describes people who do not expect Jesus to come back and who live sinfully and disobey God. These people will be surprised and judged on the "day of the Lord," since they are not "of day." So, people who want to avoid being judged on "the day of Lord" must live as people "of day," that is, as obedient and watchful people. Since Paul's day and night metaphor is directed related to the phrase "the day of the Lord," preserve the language of day and night if possible. See the notes on these verses for translation possibilities. (See: Metaphor)

Putting on armor

In 5:8, Paul commands the Thessalonians to put on armor, specifically a "breastplate" and a "helmet." A "breastplate" is armor that protects the vital organs, including the heart and lungs. Paul identifies the "breastplate" with faith and love. A "helmet" is armor that protects the head. Paul identifies the "helmet" with hope. It is unlikely that Paul expected the Thessalonians to interpret these two specific pieces of armor in special ways. Rather, Paul wants the Thessalonians to think about faith, love, and hope as if they were pieces of armor that protect them from evil powers, including sin and the devil. Since Paul uses similar armor metaphors in other letters, preserve the armor language if possible. See the notes on these verses for translation possibilities. (See: Metaphor)

Quenching the Holy Spirit

In 5:19, Paul refers to hindering the Holy Spirit as if it were "quenching" a fire. Other passages in the Bible connect the Holy Spirit with fire (for example, see Acts 2:1–4), so if possible preserve the metaphor or express

the idea as a simile. See the notes on this verse for translation options. (See: Metaphor)

1 Thessalonians 5:1 (#2)

τῶν χρόνων καὶ τῶν καιρῶν

"the times and the seasons"

Here Paul implies that **the times and the seasons** relate to questions concerning when Jesus will come back. In other words, Paul has begun to talk about the timing of Jesus' second coming. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [the times and the seasons after which Jesus will return] or [the times and the seasons related to Jesus' second coming]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:1 (#4)

ὑμῖν γράφεσθαι

"for anything} to be written to you"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who would do the action, it is clear from the context that it would be Paul and his fellow workers. Alternate translation: [for us to write anything to you]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 5:1 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Here, the word **Now** introduces a new section in the letter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a new section, or you could leave **Now** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Next,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 5:1 (#3)

τῶν χρόνων καὶ τῶν καιρῶν

"the times and the seasons"

The terms **times** and **seasons** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together to refer in general to the timing of Jesus' second coming. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express this idea with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the precise time] or [the periods of time]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 5:2 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces a reason why the Thessalonians "have no need for anything to be written" to them about the timing of Jesus' second coming. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason or basis for a previous claim. Alternate translation: [In fact,] or [Indeed,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:2 (#3)

ἔρχεται

"comes"

Here, Paul speaks of **the day of the Lord** as if it were a person who could come to a place. He means that the event named **the day of the Lord** will happen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will happen] or [occurs]

See: Personification

1 Thessalonians 5:2 (#2)

αὐτοὶ & ἀκριβῶς οἴδατε

"you yourselves know perfectly well"

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun **you**, which is already implied in the verb **know**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **yourselves**. Alternate translation: [as for you, you know perfectly well] or [it is you who know perfectly well]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 5:2 (#4)

ὡς κλέπτης ἐν νυκτὶ οὕτως ἔρχεται

"comes in this manner—as a thief in the night"

Paul is saying that **the day of the Lord** is like **a thief in the night** because people cannot tell when either one will happen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [comes in this manner—unexpectedly, as a thief comes unexpectedly in the night] or [comes when people are

not looking for it, just as thief steals in the night when people are not looking]

See: Simile

1 Thessalonians 5:2 (#5)

ὡς & οὕτως

“in this manner—as”

Having both terms **in this manner** and **as** in this sentence may be redundant in your language. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [as]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#9)

τῇ ἐν γαστρὶ ἐχούσῃ

“to the one having in the womb”

Here, the phrase **the one having in the womb** refers to a woman who is pregnant. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to a woman with child] or [to a woman who is pregnant]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#8)

ὥσπερ ἡ ὠδὶν τῇ ἐν γαστρὶ ἐχούσῃ; καὶ οὐ μὴ ἐκφύγωσιν

“just as the birth pain to the one having in the womb, and they will certainly not escape”

Paul is saying that **sudden destruction** during the day of the Lord is like **birth pain** because both events begin suddenly and cannot be avoided. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [just as the birth pain comes suddenly on the one having in the womb, and just as she cannot escape from the birth pain, so they will certainly not escape the destruction]

See: Simile

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#2)

ὅταν λέγωσιν, εἰρήνη καὶ ἀσφάλεια, τότε αἰφνίδιος & ὄλεθρος

“Whenever they say, “Peace and safety,” then sudden destruction”

Here, the word **Whenever** introduces something that is happening when the **sudden destruction comes**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that describes things that happen at the same time. Alternate translation: [While they are saying, “Peace and safety,” sudden destruction] or [They will be saying, “Peace and safety,” but then sudden destruction]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#4)

λέγωσιν & αὐτοῖς & οὐ μὴ ἐκφύγωσιν

“they say & on them & they will certainly not escape”

Here, the pronouns **they**, **them**, and **they** refer to every person who is not a believer. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [unbelievers say ... on them ... they will certainly not escape]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#3)

λέγωσιν, εἰρήνη καὶ ἀσφάλεια, τότε

“they say, “Peace and safety,” then”

It may be more natural in your language to have an indirect quotation here. Alternate translation: [they say that there is peace and safety, then]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#10)

οὐ μὴ ἐκφύγωσιν

“they will certainly not escape”

The words translated **certainly not** are two negative words. In this construction, the second negative does not cancel the first to create a positive meaning. Instead, it gives greater emphasis to the negative. If your language can use two negatives that do not cancel one another to create a positive meaning, you could use a double negative here. If your language does not use two negatives in that way, you could translate with one strong negative, as the ULT does. Alternate translation: [they will by no means escape]

See: Double Negatives

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#5)

εἰρήνη καὶ ἀσφάλεια

“Peace and safety”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **Peace** and **safety**, you could express the same

ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [We are peaceful and safe] or [We live peacefully and safely]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#6)

αἰφνίδιος αὐτοῖς ἐφίσταται ὄλεθρος, ὥσπερ ἡ ὠδὶν τῇ

"sudden destruction comes on them, just as the birth pain to the one"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **destruction**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [they will suddenly be destroyed, just as the birth pain comes to the one]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#7)

ὄλεθρος

"destruction"

Here, the word **destruction** refers to severe suffering or punishment. It does not mean that they people who experience the **destruction** cease to exist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [ruin] or [disaster]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:3 (#1)

ὅταν λέγωσιν, εἰρήνη καὶ ἀσφάλεια, τότε αἰφνίδιος αὐτοῖς ἐφίσταται ὄλεθρος

"Whenever they say, "Peace and safety," then sudden destruction comes on them"

Here Paul uses the present tense forms **say** and **comes** to refer to something that will happen in the future. He uses the present tense to indicate that these things will certainly happen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [Whenever they will be saying, "Peace and safety," then sudden destruction will come on them]

See: Predictive Past

1 Thessalonians 5:4 (#5)

ἡ ἡμέρα ὑμᾶς ὡς κλέπτας καταλάβῃ

"the day might overtake you as a thief"

Paul is saying that **the day** of the Lord will **overtake** some people as sunshine overtakes **thieves** because both the people and the thieves are surprised by and unprepared for the **day** to arrive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [the day might overtake you as daytime overtakes thieves while they are stealing] or [you are unprepared for the day as thieves are unprepared for the sun to rise]

See: Simile

1 Thessalonians 5:4 (#3)

ἐν σκότει

"in darkness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **darkness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in dark places] or [without the light]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:4 (#8)

ὡς κλέπτας

"as a thief"

Here, many ancient manuscripts read **as thieves**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read "as a thief." This reading would mean that the **day** overtakes some people **as a thief** overtakes people and steals from them. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 5:4 (#6)

ἡ ἡμέρα

"the day"

Here Paul is again referring to what he called "the day of the Lord" in 5:2. Make sure that your readers recognize that this is the same **day**, and express the idea as you did in 5:2. Alternate translation: [Jesus' second coming] or [the time when Jesus comes back]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:4 (#4)

καταλάβῃ

"might overtake"

Here, Paul speaks of **the day** as if it were a person who could **overtake** the Thessalonians. He means that the event named **the day** will not surprise or shock the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language,

you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [might surprise] or [might startle]

See: Personification

1 Thessalonians 5:4 (#1)

ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀδελφοί & ἐστὲ

"But you, brothers, are"

Here, the phrase **But you** introduces what is true about the Thessalonians in contrast to what Paul has said about unbelievers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that contrasts the Thessalonians with unbelievers. Alternate translation: [However, as for you, brothers, you are] or [In contrast, brothers, you are]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:4 (#2)

οὐκ ἐστὲ ἐν σκότει

"are not in darkness"

Here Paul speaks as if the Thessalonians are not in a place that has no light. He could mean that: (1) they are not ignorant about the day of the Lord. Alternate translation: [are not ignorant] or [know about these things]; (2) they are not avoiding and disobeying God. Alternate translation: [are not disobeying God] or [are not far away from God]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:4 (#7)

ὡς κλέπτας

"as a thief"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [as daylight overtakes thieves]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#8)

ἐσμὲν

"We are"

Here, the word **We** includes Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#4)

πάντες & ὑμεῖς υἱοὶ φωτός ἐστε, καὶ υἱοὶ ἡμέρας

"you are all sons of light and sons of day"

Here Paul speaks of the Thessalonians as if they were characterized by **light** and **day** (see the previous note for the meaning of the phrase **son of**). He means that they obey God and do what is right. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are all people who obey God and do what is right]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces a reason or basis for what Paul has said about how the "day" will not overtake the Thessalonians (see 5:2). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a reason or basis for a previous claim. Alternate translation: [In fact,] or [That is true because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#3)

πάντες & ὑμεῖς υἱοὶ φωτός ἐστε, καὶ υἱοὶ ἡμέρας

"you are all sons of light and sons of day"

The expression **son of** describes a person who shares the qualities of something. Paul is using this expression to describe the behavior and character of the Thessalonians, since they are people who are characterized by **light** and **day**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are all characterized by light and characterized by day] or [you all belong to the light and belong to the day]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#9)

σκότους

"of darkness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **darkness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [of dark places] or [without light]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#7)

οὐκ ἐσμὲν νυκτὸς οὐδὲ σκότους

"We are not of night, nor of darkness"

Here Paul speaks of believers as those who are not characterized by **night** and **darkness** (see the previous note for the meaning of the phrases **of night** and **of darkness**). He means that believers are not people who disobey God and do what is wrong. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [we are not people who disobey God and do what is wrong]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#2)

πάντες & ὑμεῖς υἱοὶ φωτός ἐστε, καὶ υἱοὶ ἡμέρας. οὐκ ἐσμὲν νυκτὸς οὐδὲ σκότους

"you are all sons of light and sons of day. We are not of night, nor of darkness"

Here, the phrases **sons of the light** and **sons of day** mean basically the same thing. Also, the phrases **of night** and **of darkness** mean basically the same thing. Paul is using these phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis by using a single phrase in each sentence. Alternate translation: [you are all sons of the day. We are not of night] or [you are all sons of the bright day. We are not of the dark night]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#5)

υἱοὶ φωτός & καὶ υἱοὶ ἡμέρας

"sons of light and sons of day"

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [children of light and children of day]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Thessalonians 5:5 (#6)

οὐκ ἐσμὲν νυκτὸς οὐδὲ σκότους

"We are not of night, nor of darkness"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe how **We** are not characterized by **night** or **darkness**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [We are not characterized by night nor characterized by darkness] or [We do not belong to the night nor do we belong to the darkness]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 5:6 (#6)

γρηγορῶμεν καὶ νήφωμεν

"let us keep watch and be sober"

Here, Paul speaks as if believers were guards who needed to **keep watch and be sober**. He means that believers should be aware of and prepared for the Lord's return, and they should be self-controlled so that they live in a way that pleases God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [let us be spiritually alert and self-controlled] or [let us confidently expect the Lord to return and live in a way that pleases God]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:6 (#4)

οἱ λοιποί

"the rest"

Paul is using the adjective **rest** as a noun to refer to a group of people that includes everyone who does not believe. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the rest of people] or [everyone else]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Thessalonians 5:6 (#2)

μὴ καθεύδωμεν & γρηγορῶμεν

"let us not sleep & let us keep watch"

Here, both times Paul uses the word **us**, it includes Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians. Your language may require you to mark these forms.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 5:6 (#3)

μὴ καθεύδωμεν

"let us not sleep"

Here Paul speaks about the people "of the night" and "of the darkness" as if they were sleeping. He means that they are unaware of or unprepared for the Lord's return because they are living sinfully. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a compa-

rable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [let us not behave sinfully and ignorantly] or [let us not act as if the Lord is not coming]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:6 (#1)

ἄρα οὖν

"So then"

Here, the phrase **So then** introduces what Paul wants believers to do in response to what he has said about Jesus' second coming. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces the application of a specific teaching. Alternate translation: [Because those things are true] or [Now that I have taught you these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:6 (#5)

οἱ λοιποί

"the rest"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the rest sleep]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 5:7 (#3)

οἱ & καθεύδοντες, νυκτὸς καθεύδουσιν; καὶ οἱ μεθυσκόμενοι, νυκτὸς μεθύουσιν

"the ones sleeping sleep at night, and the ones getting drunk get drunk at night"

Here Paul provides common examples of what people sometimes do during the **night**. He is not using **sleeping** and **getting drunk** to speak about something else. If it would be helpful in your language, you make it clearer that Paul is providing examples from regular life. Alternate translation: [here are some things that people often do at night: they sleep, or they get drunk]

1 Thessalonians 5:7 (#2)

οἱ & καθεύδοντες, νυκτὸς καθεύδουσιν; καὶ οἱ μεθυσκόμενοι, νυκτὸς μεθύουσιν

"the ones sleeping sleep at night, and the ones getting drunk get drunk at night"

Here Paul provides two parallel examples of what people do **at night**. He repeats the same structure and the phrase **at night** in both clauses, which emphasizes **at night**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could combine the two examples into one clause and emphasize **at night** in another way. Alternate translation: [it is at night that people sleep and drunkards get drunk] or [the ones sleeping and the ones getting drunk do so during the night]

See: Parallelism

1 Thessalonians 5:7 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word **For** introduces a further explanation of the contrast between night and day (see 5:8). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a further explanation, or you could leave **For** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Indeed,] or [As you know,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#2)

ἡμεῖς

"us"

Here, the word **us** includes Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#1)

δὲ

"But"

Here, the word **But** introduces a contrast with the people who "sleep" and "get drunk" during the night (see 5:7). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that contrasts two groups of people. Alternate translation: [In contrast,] or [Unlike them,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#9)

περικεφαλαίαν

"a helmet"

A **helmet** is a strong hat that a soldier would wear to protect his or her head. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of armor, you could use the

name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a protective hat] or [something to protect our heads]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#4)

ἡμέρας

"of day"

Here, the phrase **of day** means basically the same thing as the phrase "sons of day" in 5:5. Paul means that believers obey God and do what is right, just as people usually do what is right during the **day**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people who obey God and do what is right]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#5)

ἡμεῖς δὲ ἡμέρας ὄντες, νήφωμεν

"But let us, being of day, be sober"

Here, the phrase **be sober** contrasts with the phrase "get drunk" in the previous verse (5:7). Paul means that believers should be self-controlled and obedient to God. He does not just mean that they should not get drunk, although that is part of the command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [But let us, being of day, not get drunk but be self-controlled]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#6)

ἐνδυσάμενοι θώρακα πίστεως καὶ ἀγάπης, καὶ περικεφαλαίαν, ἐλπίδα σωτηρίας

"having put on the breastplate of faith and of love, and a helmet—the hope of salvation"

Here Paul speaks of Christians acting in **faith** and **love** as if each of them were a soldier putting on a **breastplate**. He speaks of Christians experiencing **the hope of salvation** as if each of them were a soldier putting on a **helmet**. He means that **faith**, **love**, and **hope** protect believers, just as armor protects soldiers. Paul does not directly state what believers are protected from, but he implies that it is sin and evil powers, including the devil. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a simile or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [acting in faith and love as if they were a breastplate you could put on, and having the hope of salvation as if it were a helmet you would wear] or [protecting yourselves by acting in faith and love and by having the hope of salvation]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#10)

ἐλπίδα σωτηρίας

"the hope of salvation"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe **hope** that is focused on **salvation**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the hope for salvation] or [the hope that expects salvation]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#8)

θώρακα πίστεως καὶ ἀγάπης

"the breastplate of faith and of love"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to define **the breastplate** as **faith** and **love**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a breastplate, which is faith and love] or [the breastplate that is faith and love]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#7)

θώρακα πίστεως καὶ ἀγάπης, καὶ περικεφαλαίαν, ἐλπίδα σωτηρίας

"the breastplate of faith and of love, and a helmet—the hope of salvation"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **faith**, **love**, **hope**, and **salvation**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [the breastplate, which stands for believing God and loving people, and a helmet, which stands for hoping that God will save us]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:8 (#3)

ἡμέρας ὄντες

"being of day"

Here, the phrase **being of day** provides a reason why the Thessalonians should **be sober**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could include a word or phrase that introduces a reason. Alternate translation: [because we are of day]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:9 (#1)

ὅτι

“For”

Here, the word **For** introduces a reason why the Thessalonians should do what Paul has commanded them to do in 5:6–8. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces the reason or basis for previous commands. Alternate translation: [You should do those things because] or [I urge you to do those things since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:9 (#3)

εἰς ὀργὴν

“for wrath”

Here, the word **wrath** refers to how God will punish people who do not believe and who disobey him. This punishment will occur during “the day of the Lord” that Paul has already mentioned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [for future punishment] or [to experience punishment when Jesus returns]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:9 (#5)

ἀλλὰ εἰς

“but for”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but he appointed us for]

See: Ellipsis

1 Thessalonians 5:9 (#6)

εἰς περιποίησιν σωτηρίας

“for the obtaining of salvation”

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe **obtaining** something, which is **salvation**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for obtaining salvation] or [to obtain salvation]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 5:9 (#4)

εἰς ὀργὴν

“for wrath”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wrath**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to be punished]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:9 (#2)

ἡμᾶς & ἡμῶν

“us & our”

Here, the words **us** and **our** include Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians. Your language may require you to mark these forms.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 5:9 (#7)

εἰς περιποίησιν σωτηρίας

“for the obtaining of salvation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to be saved]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:10 (#2)

ἡμῶν & γρηγορῶμεν & ζήσωμεν

“us & we keep watch & we will live”

Here, the words **us**, **we**, and **we** include Paul, his fellow workers, and the Thessalonians. Your language may require you to mark these forms.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 5:10 (#1)

τοῦ ἀποθανόντος περὶ ἡμῶν

“the one having died for us”

Here, the phrase **the one having died for us** gives more information about “our Lord Jesus Christ.” It does not distinguish between several Christs. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that adds information instead of making distinctions. Alternate translation: [and he is the one who died for us] or [who died for us]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 5:10 (#5)

εἴτε γρηγορῶμεν εἴτε καθεύδωμεν

"whether we keep watch or sleep"

Here Paul could be using the terms **keep watch** and **sleep** to refer to: (1) being alive and being dead. Alternate translation: [whether we are alive or die]; (2) waiting expectantly for Jesus to return and being dead. Alternate translation: [whether we continue to expect Jesus to return or have died]; (3) doing what pleases God and not doing what pleases God. Alternate translation: [whether we do not always please God or whether we do what pleases him]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:10 (#3)

περὶ ἡμῶν

"for us"

Here, the phrase **for us** could indicate that Jesus **died**: (1) to benefit or help us. Alternate translation: [for our benefit]; (2) instead of or in place of us. Alternate translation: [in place of us] or [instead of us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:10 (#4)

ἵνα

"so that"

Here, the phrase **so that** introduces the purpose for which Jesus **died**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:11 (#1)

διὸ

"Therefore"

Here, the word **Therefore** introduces what Paul wants the Thessalonians to do in response to what he has told them about Jesus' second coming and how to be ready for it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces the application of a specific teaching. Alternate translation: [So then] or [Now that I have taught you these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:11 (#3)

οἰκοδομεῖτε εἷς τὸν ἕνα

"build up one the one"

Here, Paul is speaking of the Thessalonian believers as if they were a building. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [help one the one become more faithful to Christ]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:11 (#4)

εἷς τὸν ἕνα

"one the one"

Here, the phrase **one the one** indicates that each person should be building up each other person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that refers to people building each other up. Alternate translation: [one another]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 5:11 (#2)

παρακαλεῖτε ἀλλήλους, καὶ οἰκοδομεῖτε εἷς τὸν ἕνα

"encourage one another and build up one the one"

The commands **encourage one another** and **build up one the one** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [encourage one another] or [build one another up]

See: Doublet

1 Thessalonians 5:11 (#5)

καθὼς καὶ ποιεῖτε

"just as also you are doing"

Here Paul means that the Thessalonians are already doing what he is asking them to do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [which indeed you are already doing for each other]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:12 (#3)

τοὺς κοπιῶντας ἐν ὑμῖν, καὶ προϊσταμένους ὑμῶν ἐν Κυρίῳ, καὶ νουθετοῦντας ὑμᾶς

"the ones laboring among you and leading you in the Lord and admonishing you"

Here Paul could be using these three phrases: (1) to refer to three distinct activities. Alternate translation:

[the ones laboring among you, leading you in the Lord, and admonishing you]; (2) to refer to one primary activity (**laboring**) that he defines as **leading** and **admonishing**. Alternate translation: [the ones laboring among you by leading you in the Lord and by admonishing you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:12 (#4)

ἐν Κυρίῳ

"in the Lord"

Here Paul uses the spatial metaphor **in the Lord** to describe the union of believers with **the Lord**. In this case, being **in the Lord**, or united to Christ, could: (1) identify the leaders as those who lead people who believe in Christ. Alternate translation: [as Christians] or [as Christ's people]; (2) indicate that **the Lord** has authorized these leaders. Alternate translation: [as the Lord has authorized them] or [as representatives of the Lord]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:12 (#2)

τοὺς κοπιῶντας ἐν ὑμῖν, καὶ προϊσταμένους ὑμῶν ἐν Κυρίῳ, καὶ νουθετοῦντας ὑμᾶς

"the ones laboring among you and leading you in the Lord and admonishing you"

Here Paul is describing one group of people who do three different things. He is not making distinctions between three different groups. Make sure that your translation refers to only one group of people. Alternate translation: [the people who labor among you, who lead you in the Lord, and who admonish you] or [your leaders who labor among you and lead you in the Lord and admonish you]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Thessalonians 5:12 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Here, the word **Now** introduces a new section in the letter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a new section, or you could leave **Now** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Further,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 5:13 (#5)

εἰρηνεύετε

"Be at peace"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Act peaceably]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:13 (#3)

ἡγεῖσθαι αὐτοὺς ὑπέρἐκπερισσοῦ

"to regard them highly"

Here, the phrase **regard them highly** means that the Thessalonians should greatly respect and honor their leaders in the church. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable phrase or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to hold them in high esteem] or [to treat them with respect]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 5:13 (#2)

ἡγεῖσθαι αὐτοὺς ὑπέρἐκπερισσοῦ ἐν ἀγάπῃ

"to regard them highly in love"

Here, the phrase **in love** could give: (1) the context in which the Thessalonians should **regard them highly**. In other words, the Thessalonians should **regard them highly** while they are loving them. Alternate translation: [while you are loving them to regard them highly]; (2) the manner in which the Thessalonians should **regard them highly**. Alternate translation: [to regard them highly by loving them] or [to regard them with great love]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:13 (#1)

καὶ ἡγεῖσθαι αὐτοὺς ὑπέρἐκπερισσοῦ ἐν ἀγάπῃ, διὰ τὸ ἔργον αὐτῶν

"and to regard them highly in love because of their work"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the reason before the result. Alternate translation: [and, because of their work, to regard them highly in love]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:13 (#4)

ἐν ἀγάπῃ

“in love”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **love**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and in a loving way] or [and love them]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:14 (#3)

τοὺς ἀτάκτους

“the disorderly”

Here, the word **disorderly** could describe: (1) people who live in undisciplined and disruptive ways. Alternate translation: [the undisciplined]; (2) people who refuse to work to support themselves. Alternate translation: [the idle] or [the lazy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:14 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Here, the word **Now** introduces a new section in the letter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a new section, or you could leave **Now** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Next,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 5:14 (#2)

νουθετεῖτε τοὺς ἀτάκτους, παραμυθεῖσθε τοὺς ὀλιγοψύχους, ἀντέχεσθε τῶν ἀσθενῶν, μακροθυμεῖτε πρὸς πάντας

“Admonish the disorderly, comfort the discouraged, help the weak, be patient toward all”

Paul is using the adjectives **disorderly**, **discouraged**, **weak**, and **all** as nouns to refer to groups of people who can be described by these adjectives. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [Admonish disorderly people, comfort discouraged people, help weak people, be patient toward all people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Thessalonians 5:14 (#4)

πάντας

“all”

Here, the word **all** could refer to: (1) people in general. Alternate translation: [all people]; (2) just believers. Alternate translation: [all believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:15 (#2)

κακὸν ἀντὶ κακοῦ τινι ἀποδῷ

“repays evil for evil to anyone”

Here Paul means that the Thessalonians should not do what is **evil** to people who have done what is **evil**. In other words, when someone treats them badly, they should not respond in the same way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar phrase or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [retaliates against anyone who hurts you] or [responds with evil to anyone who does evil]

See: Idiom

1 Thessalonians 5:15 (#5)

καὶ εἰς ἀλλήλους καὶ εἰς πάντας

“both for one another and for all”

Here, the phrase **one another** refers to the believers in Thessalonica. The word **all** refers to all people, whether they are believers or not. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make these ideas more explicit. Alternate translation: [both for your fellow believers and for all people] or [both for each other and for all other people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:15 (#6)

πάντας

“all”

Paul is using the adjective **all** as a noun to refer to a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [all people] or [everybody]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Thessalonians 5:15 (#1)

ὁρᾶτε

“See that”

Here Paul tells the Thessalonians to see or look at what he wants them to do. He means that he wants them to make sure that it happens. If it would be

clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Ensure that]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:15 (#3)

ἀλλὰ

"but"

Here, the word **but** introduces a command that is in contrast with repaying **evil for evil**. Use a natural way in your language for introducing this kind of contrast. Alternate translation: [and instead,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:15 (#4)

διώκετε

"pursue"

Here Paul speaks as if he wants the Corinthians to run after and try to capture **{what is} good**. He speaks in this way because he wants them to do **{what is} good** as persistently as someone who pursues someone or something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [seek after] or [try to do]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:17 (#1)

ἀδιαλείπτως

"continually"

Paul says **continually** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [very regularly] or [extremely often]

See: Hyperbole

1 Thessalonians 5:18 (#5)

θέλημα Θεοῦ ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ εἰς ὑμᾶς

"the will of God in Christ Jesus for you"

Here Paul could mean: (1) that the **will of God** has been revealed **in Christ Jesus**. Alternate translation: [the will of God that has been revealed in Christ Jesus for you] or [the will of God as Christ Jesus has shown it to you]; (2) that the **will of God** is for people who are **in Christ Jesus**. In other words, these commands are what God wants people who are in union with **Christ Jesus** to do. Alternate translation: [the will of God for you who are united to Christ Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:18 (#1)

ἐν παντὶ

"In everything"

Here, the phrase **In everything** could refer to: (1) every situation or experience. Alternate translation: [In everything that you experience] or [In every circumstance]; (2) every moment in time. Alternate translation: [At every time] or [At all times]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:18 (#3)

τοῦτο

"this {is"

Here, the word **this** could refer to: (1) the three commands in 5:16–18. Alternate translation: [these are]; (2) just the command to **give thanks**. Alternate translation: [that is]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 5:18 (#2)

εὐχαριστεῖτε & γὰρ

"give thanks, for"

Here, the word **for** could introduce a reason or basis for: (1) the three commands in 5:16–18. Alternate translation: [give thanks. Do these things since]; (2) just the command to **give thanks**. Alternate translation: [give thanks, which you should do since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:18 (#4)

θέλημα Θεοῦ

"the will of God"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **will**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what God desires]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:19 (#1)

τὸ Πνεῦμα μὴ σβέννυτε

"Do not quench the Spirit"

Paul speaks of the Holy **Spirit** as if he were a fire that the Thessalonians should not **quench**. Paul means that the Thessalonians should not hinder or oppose the work of the Holy **Spirit**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not restrain the Spirit] or [Do not hinder the Spirit]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:20 (#1)

μὴ ἐξουθενεῖτε

"Do not despise"

Here Paul may be giving a specific example of his command not to "quench the Spirit" in 5:19. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this connection more explicit. Alternate translation: [Specifically, do not despise] or [For example, do not despise]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 5:20 (#2)

μὴ ἐξουθενεῖτε

"Do not despise"

Paul is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning, **despise**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [Honor] or [Respect]

See: Litotes

1 Thessalonians 5:21 (#1)

πάντα δοκιμάζετε

"Test all things"

Here, many ancient manuscripts read **Test all things**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read "But test all things." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 5:21 (#2)

πάντα δοκιμάζετε; τὸ καλὸν κατέχετε

"Test all things. Hold fast to what {is} good"

Here Paul could be referring to: (1) the "prophecies" that he referred to in the previous verse (see 5:20). Alternate translation: [Test all prophecies. Hold fast to those that are good]; (2) spiritual gifts, or how the Holy Spirit specially empowers each person. Alternate translation: [Test all spiritual gifts. Hold fast to those that do what is good]; (3) anything people say and do. Alternate translation: [Test all things that people say and do. Hold fast to those that are good]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:21 (#3)

τὸ καλὸν κατέχετε

"Hold fast to what {is} good"

Here Paul speaks as if **what {is} good** were an object that the Thessalonians could grasp tightly. He means that they should believe and act based on whatever is **good**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Adhere to what is good] or [Follow what is good]

See: Metaphor

1 Thessalonians 5:22 (#2)

παντὸς εἴδους πονηροῦ

"every form of evil"

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe **every form** that is characterized by **evil**. If this is not clear in your language, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [every form that evil takes] or [evil in any form]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 5:22 (#1)

ἀπὸ παντὸς εἴδους πονηροῦ ἀπέχεσθε

"Keep yourselves from every form of evil"

Here, much as in the previous verse (5:22), Paul could be referring to: (1) the "prophecies" that he referred to in 5:20. Alternate translation: [Keep yourselves from every form of evil prophecy]; (2) spiritual gifts, or how the Holy Spirit specially empowers each person. Alternate translation: [Keep yourselves from every form of spiritual gift that does what is evil]; (3) anything people say and do. Alternate translation: [Keep yourselves from every form of what people say and do that is evil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:22 (#3)

εἴδους

“form”

Here, the word translated **form** could refer to: (1) a type or kind of something. Alternate translation: [type]; (2) the way that something looks or appears. Alternate translation: [appearance]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#8)

ὁλόκληρον ὑμῶν τὸ πνεῦμα, καὶ ἡ ψυχὴ, καὶ τὸ σῶμα

“your whole spirit, and soul, and body”

Here Paul uses the three terms **spirit**, **soul**, and **body** together to refer to the whole person. These three terms could: (1) describe different aspects of the whole person from different perspectives. In this case, the three terms do not define three separate pieces that together make up a person. You could use fewer or more terms to refer to different aspects of the person. Alternate translation: [your whole body and soul] or [your whole life, mind, feelings, and desires]; (2) describe three separate pieces that together make up a person. In this case, you should use two terms to refer to two different non-physical parts (**spirit** and **soul**) and one term to refer to one physical part (**body**). Alternate translation: [your whole mind, and life, and flesh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#9)

ἀμέμπτως

“blamelessly”

Here, the word **blamelessly** could refer to: (1) the situation in which the **spirit**, **soul**, and **body** are **kept**. Alternate translation: [in a blameless state]; (2) the result of the **spirit**, **soul**, and **body** being **kept**. Alternate translation: [so that they are blameless]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#5)

αὐτὸς & ὁ Θεὸς τῆς εἰρήνης ἁγιάσαι

“may the God of peace himself sanctify”

For emphasis, Paul is stating the pronoun “he,” which is already implied in the phrase **the God of peace**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **himself**. Alternate translation: [may he who is the God of peace sanctify] or [may the God of peace indeed sanctify]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#4)

ὁ Θεὸς τῆς εἰρήνης

“the God of peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the idea in another way. Make sure that your translation fits the option you chose in the previous note about how **God** and **peace** relate. Alternate translation: [the peaceful God] or [the God who makes people peaceful]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Here, the word **Now** introduces a new section, a blessing from Paul to the Thessalonians. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word or phrase that introduces a new section, or you could leave **Now** untranslated. Alternate translation: [Next,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#7)

ὁλόκληρον ὑμῶν τὸ πνεῦμα, καὶ ἡ ψυχὴ, καὶ τὸ σῶμα, ἀμέμπτως & τηρηθείη

“may your whole spirit, and soul, and body be kept blamelessly”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, it is clear from the context that it is God. Alternate translation: [may he keep blamelessly your whole spirit, and soul, and body]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#6)

καὶ

“and”

Here, the word **and** could introduce: (1) a second blessing or prayer. Alternate translation: [and also]; (2) a more specific explanation of the first blessing or

prayer. Alternate translation: [that is,] or [and more specifically,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#11)

ἡμῶν

“our”

Here, the word **our** includes Paul, Silvanus, Timothy, the Thessalonians, and all believers. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#3)

ὁ Θεὸς τῆς εἰρήνης

“the God of peace”

Here Paul uses the possessive form **the God of peace**, which is a title for God found in the New Testament (see Romans 15:33; 16:20; Philippians 4:9; Hebrews 13:20). In this context, the phrase **the God of peace** could refer to: (1) what God does. Alternate translation: [the God who gives peace]; (2) who God is. Alternate translation: [the God who is characterized by peace]; (3) Both. Alternate translation: [the peaceful God who gives peace]

See: Possession

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#10)

ἐν τῇ παρουσίᾳ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ”

Here, the phrase **the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ** refers to the specific time in the future when Jesus will come back to earth, judge everyone, punish unbelievers, and reward believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. See how you translated the similar phrase in 4:15. Alternate translation: [when our Lord Jesus Christ comes back to earth] or [at return of our Lord Jesus Christ to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:23 (#2)

αὐτὸς & ὁ Θεὸς τῆς εἰρήνης ἁγιάσαι ὑμᾶς ὁλοτελεῖς, καὶ ὁλόκληρον ὑμῶν τὸ πνεῦμα, καὶ ἡ ψυχὴ, καὶ τὸ σῶμα, ἀμέμπτως ἐν τῇ παρουσίᾳ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, τηρηθείη

“may the God of peace himself sanctify you completely, and may your whole spirit, and soul, and body be kept blamelessly at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ”

Here Paul is asking God to bless the Thessalonians. You could express this as either a blessing or a prayer, in whichever way is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we ask the God of peace himself to sanctify you completely, and we ask that your whole spirit, and soul, and body be kept blamelessly at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Blessings

1 Thessalonians 5:24 (#2)

ὁ καλῶν ὑμᾶς, ὃς

“is} the one calling you, who”

Here, the pronouns **he** and **who** refer to “the God of peace” (see 5:23). If it would be helpful in your language, you could refer directly to God. Alternate translation: [is God who calls you, who]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Thessalonians 5:24 (#1)

πιστὸς ὁ καλῶν ὑμᾶς, ὃς καὶ ποιήσει

“Faithful {is} the one calling you, who also will do {it”

Here, the clause **Faithful {is} the one calling you** gives the reason why God will be the one **who will also do {it}**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make the relationship more explicit. Alternate translation: [Because the one calling you is faithful, he also will do it]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Thessalonians 5:24 (#3)

ποιήσει

“will do {it”

Here Paul does not state directly what God **will do**. He implies that God will do what Paul prayed for in the previous verse (see 5:23). If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [will do those things] or [will do what I have prayed for]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:25 (#1)

προσεύχεσθε καὶ

“pray also”

Here, **also** indicates that the Thessalonians should be praying for Paul, Silas, and Timothy just as Paul, Silas, and Timothy pray for them (see 5:23). If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [just as we pray for you, pray also]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:26 (#1)

ἐν φιλήματι ἁγίῳ

"with a holy kiss"

A **holy kiss** was a symbolic action to show familial love between believers. In some cultures, a kiss as a greeting is appropriate, but in other cultures it is not appropriate. The idea of a **holy kiss** is that it be a greeting that is appropriate in the culture, whether it be a kiss, a hug, a handshake, or something else, and also that it be holy, that is, appropriate between God's people. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [warmly, as fellow believers]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Thessalonians 5:27 (#4)

πᾶσιν τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

"to all the brothers"

Many ancient manuscripts read **all the brothers**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read "all the holy brothers." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:27 (#3)

ἀναγνωσθῆναι τὴν ἐπιστολὴν

"to have this letter read"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to have someone read this letter]

See: Active or Passive

1 Thessalonians 5:27 (#2)

ἀναγνωσθῆναι τὴν ἐπιστολὴν

"to have this letter read"

In Paul's culture, letters sent to a group were normally **read** out loud by one person to everyone else in the group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this idea more explicit. Alternate translation: [to have this letter read by somebody out loud]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Thessalonians 5:27 (#1)

ἐνορκίζω ὑμᾶς τὸν Κύριον

"I solemnly charge you {by} the Lord"

The phrase **{by} the Lord** could be: (1) an oath formula. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I make you swear before the Lord] or [I solemnly require that you promise the Lord]; (2) Paul's claim that **the Lord** has authorized him. Alternate translation: [As one who represents the Lord, I solemnly charge you]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Thessalonians 5:28 (#4)

μεθ' ὑμῶν

"be} with you"

Here, many ancient manuscripts read **{be} with you**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts add "Amen" after **{be} with you**. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Thessalonians 5:28 (#2)

ἡ χάρις τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, μεθ' ὑμῶν

"The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ {be} with you"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the idea in another way. Alternate translation: [May our Lord Jesus Christ act graciously toward you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Thessalonians 5:28 (#1)

ἡ χάρις τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, μεθ' ὑμῶν

"The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ {be} with you"

As was customary in his culture, Paul closes his letter with a blessing for the Thessalonians. Use a form

1 Thessalonians 5:28 (#3)

that people would recognize as a blessing in your language. Alternate translation: [May you experience kindness from our Lord Jesus Christ within you] or [I pray that you will have grace from our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Blessings

1 Thessalonians 5:28 (#3)

ἡμῶν

“our”

Here, the word **our** includes Paul, Silvanus, Timothy, the Thessalonians, and all believers. Your language may require you to mark this form.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information